

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Topic IV — Human Rights, Human Dignity, Women and the Family

The Question Answers · Every past-paper question of Topic 4, 2015–2026,
answered as a model

Twelve model answers — the family twice, women five times, human rights and dignity five times. Each begins with an answer map that states exactly what the question asks, builds its headings from the question's own words, and proves every heading from the Quran, the Sunnah and the scholars.

Contents

HOW TO BUILD THE CONTENTS

The Contents below is left empty on purpose. In Microsoft Word, **right-click anywhere on the grey line below** and choose **Update Field** → **Update entire table** → **OK**. The full table of contents with page numbers will appear.

On a Mac: right-click (or Control-click) the line → **Update Field**. If you edit the notes later, repeat this step to refresh the page numbers. You can also press **Ctrl + A** then **F9** (Windows) to update every field in the document at once.

How to Use These Answers	6
What is in this document	6
How every answer is built	6
Answer 1 · The Last Sermon as the Basic Document of Human Rights (CSS 2020)	7
Decoding the question	7
The model answer	7
(1) Introduction	7
(2) The human rights declared in the Sermon	8
(3) Why it is the 'basic document' of human rights	10
(4) Why it 'awakened the conscience' of mankind	10
(5) Compared with the later charters	11
(6) An honest note	11
(7) Conclusion	11
Why this answer scores	11
Answer 2 · Short Notes: Human Rights in the Farewell Sermon; Social Justice in an Islamic Society (CSS 2023)	13
Decoding the question	13
The model answer	13
(i) Human rights in the light of the Sermon of the Farewell Pilgrimage	13
(ii) Social justice in an Islamic society	15
Why this answer scores	16
Answer 3 · Human Respect and Dignity Irrespective of Colour, Race and Creed (CSS 2020)	17
Decoding the question	17
The model answer	18
(1) Introduction	18
(2) The basis of human dignity	18
(3) Dignity irrespective of colour	19
(4) Dignity irrespective of race	19
(5) Dignity irrespective of creed	20

(6) Equality before the law — the practical test	20
(7) The modern relevance.....	21
(8) Conclusion	21
Why this answer scores	21
Answer 4 · How Islam Highlights Human Dignity and Greatness (CSS 2024)	22
Decoding the question.....	22
The model answer	23
(1) Introduction	23
(2) Greatness in his creation	23
(3) Greatness in his position and role	24
(4) Dignity of every human being — equality.....	25
(5) Dignity protected by law	25
(6) Dignity in every condition.....	26
(7) The scholars	27
(8) Dignity carries responsibility	27
(9) Conclusion	27
Why this answer scores	28
Answer 5 · Islam and the UDHR: A Comparative and Critical Analysis (CSS 2026)	29
Decoding the question.....	29
The model answer	29
(1) Introduction	29
(2) The similarities	30
(3) The differences.....	30
(4) Critical analysis of the UDHR and its practice.....	31
(5) Critical analysis of Muslim practice	32
(6) Verdict and conclusion	32
Why this answer scores	32
Answer 6 · Human Rights in Islamic Thought, with the Status of Women (CSS 2022)	33
Decoding the question.....	33
The model answer	34
(1) Introduction	34
(2) The concept of human rights in Islamic thought.....	34
(3) The status of women as human beings.....	34
(4) The rights of women	35
(5) The gap in practice — Pakistan.....	37
(6) Conclusion	37
Why this answer scores	38
Answer 7 · Islam Provides Better Rights to Men and Women than All Other Religions (CSS 2021)	39

Decoding the question.....	39
The model answer	40
(1) Introduction	40
(2) The basis — one humanity, no blame on woman	40
(3) Better rights for women — the comparison.....	40
(4) Better rights for men.....	41
(5) The balance of rights and duties.....	42
(6) An honest limit.....	43
(7) Conclusion	43
Why this answer scores	43
Answer 8 · The Rights of Daughters in Islam and Their Denial by Muslims Today (CSS 2023)	44
Decoding the question.....	44
The model answer	45
(1) Introduction	45
(2) The rights of daughters granted by Islam	45
(3) How these rights are denied by Muslims today	47
(4) Why — the causes.....	48
(5) The remedy	48
(6) Conclusion	48
Why this answer scores	48
Answer 9 · The Right of Inheritance Granted to Women by Islam (CSS 2017)	49
Decoding the question.....	49
The model answer	49
(1) Introduction	49
(2) The Quranic declaration of the right	50
(3) The shares of women in the Quran.....	50
(4) Why a son receives twice a daughter — the wisdom.....	51
(5) Cases where women receive equal or more	51
(6) Rules that protect her share.....	51
(7) The denial of women's inheritance today	52
(8) Conclusion	52
Why this answer scores	52
Answer 10 · The Rights of Women in Islam and the Current Wave of Feminism (CSS 2019).....	53
Decoding the question.....	53
The model answer	53
(1) Introduction	53
(2) The feminist movement — its waves.....	54
(3) The rights of women in Islam	54

(4) Where Islam agrees with the demands of the movement	56
(5) Where Islam differs.....	56
(6) Custom, not Islam — the real oppressor	56
(7) Conclusion	57
Why this answer scores	57
Answer 11 · The Stability of Modern Society Depends on a Strong Family System (CSS 2015)	58
Decoding the question.....	58
The model answer	59
(1) Introduction	59
(2) The Islamic principles of the family.....	59
(3) How a strong family keeps society stable.....	60
(4) Islamic safeguards that keep the family strong.....	60
(5) What happens when the family fails — the modern evidence.....	61
(6) Conclusion	61
Why this answer scores	61
Answer 12 · The Challenges for the Institution of Family in the Present Era (CSS 2026)	63
Decoding the question.....	63
The model answer	64
(1) Introduction — the role of the family	64
(2) Social challenges.....	64
(3) Technological challenges.....	65
(4) Economic challenges.....	65
(5) Ideological challenges.....	66
(6) Injustice within families	66
(7) The Islamic remedies.....	66
(8) Conclusion	67
Why this answer scores	67

How to Use These Answers

What is in this document

#	Paper	Question (short)	Answer
1	2020 Q4	The Last Sermon — the basic document for awakening mankind's conscience for human rights	Answer 1
2	2023 Q8	Notes: human rights in the Farewell Sermon; social justice in an Islamic society	Answer 2
3	2020 Q7	Human respect and dignity irrespective of colour, race and creed	Answer 3
4	2024 Q5	How Islam highlights human dignity and greatness	Answer 4
5	2026 Q2	Islam and the UDHR — comparative and critical analysis	Answer 5
6	2022 Q2	Human rights in Islamic thought, specifying the status of women	Answer 6
7	2021 Q3	Islam gives better rights to men and women than all other religions	Answer 7
8	2023 Q4	Rights of daughters, and how Muslims deny them today	Answer 8
9	2017 Q3	The right of inheritance granted to women	Answer 9
10	2019 Q4	Rights of women in the context of the feminist movement	Answer 10
11	2015 Q8	Stability of society depends on a strong family system	Answer 11
12	2026 Q8	Challenges to the institution of the family in the present era	Answer 12

How every answer is built

1. **The question**, exactly as set.
2. **The answer map** — the centre states **exactly what the question asks**, limb by limb; every box is a heading, and every point is a complete idea (the verse or hadith and its point).
3. **Decoding the question** — the command words and what each limb demands.
4. **The model answer** — headings from the question's own words; evidence in the order **Quran** → **Hadith** → **Companions** → **scholars**; figures; the Pakistan angle; a conclusion with a verse or hadith.
5. **Why this answer scores.**

TRAP · USE THE ANSWERS AS MODELS, NOT SCRIPTS

Learn the structure and the evidence; build your headings from the words of the question you are given. A model answer is fuller than you can write in 33 minutes — choose the headings and evidence you can reproduce well.

Answer 1 · The Last Sermon as the Basic Document of Human Rights (CSS 2020)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2020 · Q4 · 20 marks

"The last Sermon of the Holy Prophet (PBUH) is the basic document for awakening of conscience of mankind for human rights". Discuss.

Prove 'basic document' (content) and 'awakening conscience' (method), then compare with later charters.

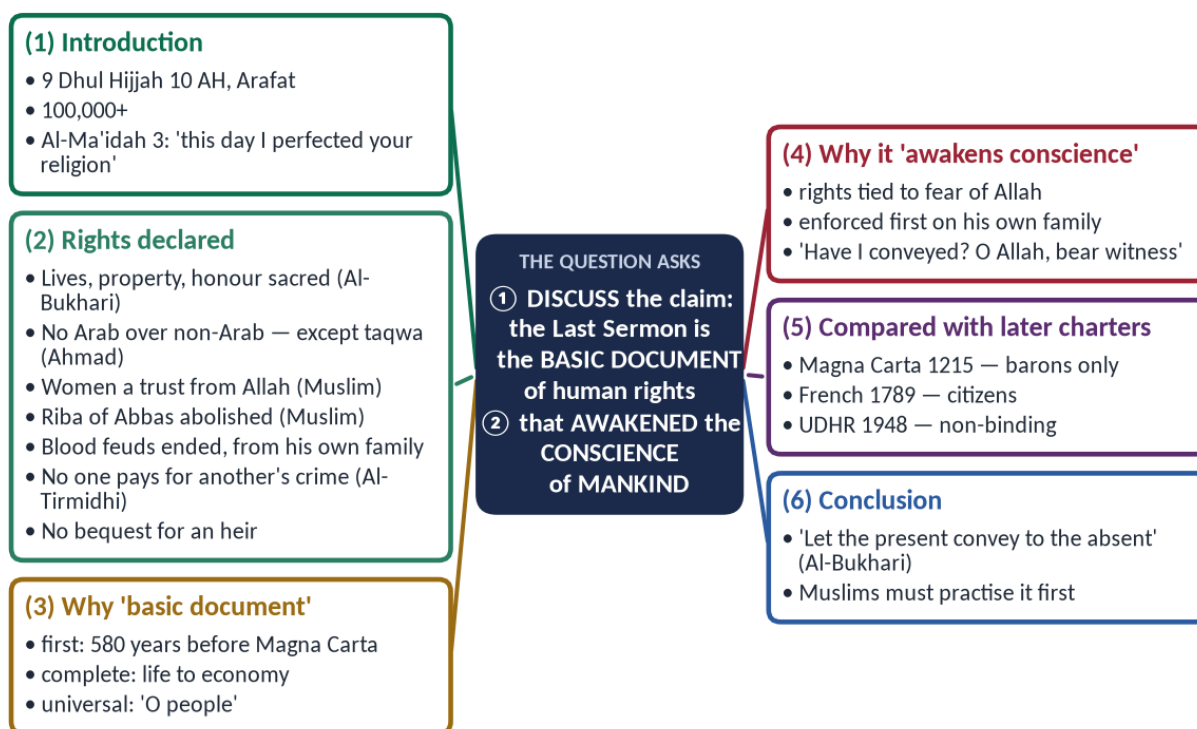


Figure 1 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- 'Discuss' = examine the claim with evidence; agree with reasons and note any limits.
- 'Basic document' = show its **content** — the rights it declared — and its **priority** in time.
- 'Awakening of conscience' = show **how** it moves hearts: rights tied to faith, set by example.
- 'Of mankind' = its **universal** address.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

On 9 Dhul Hijjah 10 AH (632), on the plain of Arafat, the Prophet ﷺ addressed more than a hundred thousand people in what became his Farewell Sermon — Khutbat Hajjat al-Wada' (خُطْبَةُ حَجَّةِ الْوَدَاعِ). On that day was revealed:

✦ QURAN

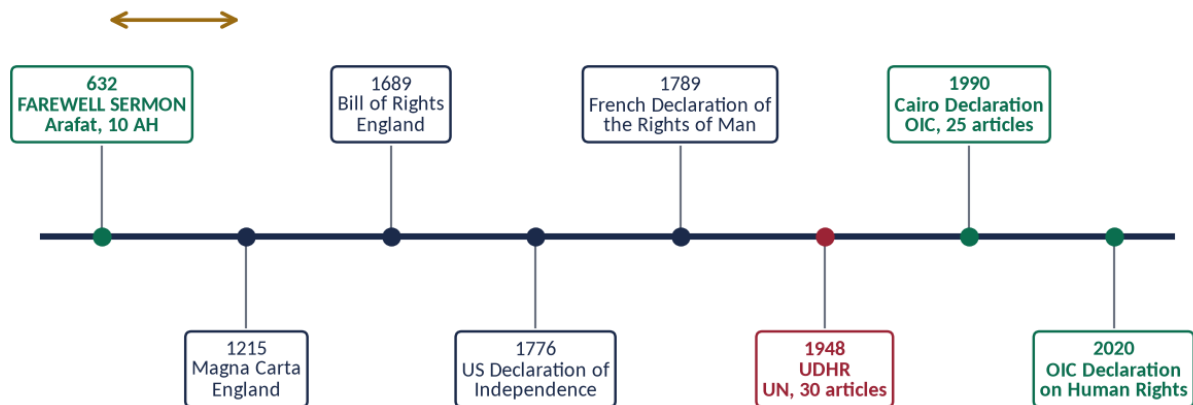
﴿... الْيَوْمَ أَكْمَلْتُ لَكُمْ دِينَكُمْ وَأَتِمَمْتُ عَلَيْكُمْ نِعْمَتِي وَرَضِيتُ لَكُمُ الْإِسْلَامَ دِينًا ...﴾

"This day I have perfected for you your religion, completed My favour upon you, and approved for you Islam as religion." (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ 'This day I have perfected for you your religion' — the sermon stands at the completion of Islam.

It was his last public address and his summary of the rights of human beings. This answer shows that it is indeed the **basic document** of human rights and that it **awakened the conscience** of mankind.

about 580 years earlier than Magna Carta



The Farewell Sermon was addressed to all mankind ('O people'), not to a king's barons or one nation's citizens.

Figure 2 · The Farewell Sermon and the later charters of rights.

(2) The human rights declared in the Sermon

(i) Life, property and honour

✦ HADITH

فَإِنَّ دِمَاءَكُمْ وَأَمْوَالَكُمْ وَأَعْرَاضَكُمْ عَلَيْكُمْ حَرَامٌ، كَحُرْمَةِ يَوْمِكُمْ هَذَا

"Your lives, your property and your honour are sacred to one another, like the sanctity of this day." (Al-Bukhari)

→ The **three basic rights** of every later charter.

(ii) Equality of all human beings

✦ FROM THE SIRAH

أَلَا لَا فَضْلَ لِعَرَبِيٍّ عَلَى عَجَمِيٍّ، وَلَا لِعَجَمِيٍّ عَلَى عَرَبِيٍّ، وَلَا لِأَحْمَرَ عَلَى أَسْوَدَ، وَلَا لِأَسْوَدَ عَلَى أَحْمَرَ، إِلَّا بِالتَّقْوَى

"No Arab has superiority over a non-Arab, nor a non-Arab over an Arab, nor white over black, nor black over white — except by taqwa." (Musnad Ahmad (the Farewell Sermon))

→ The **end of racism** by declaration.

(iii) The rights of women

✦ HADITH

فَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ فِي النِّسَاءِ، فَإِنَّكُمْ أَخَذْتُمُوهُنَّ بِأَمَانٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ

“Fear Allah concerning women, for you have taken them as a trust from Allah.” (Muslim)

→ Women a **trust**; their maintenance and kind treatment a right.

(iv) Economic justice — riba abolished

✦ HADITH

وَرِبَا الْجَاهِلِيَّةِ مَوْضُوعٌ، وَأَوَّلُ رَبًّا أَضْعُ رَبَانَا رَبَا عَبَّاسِ بْنِ عَبْدِ الْمُطَّلِبِ

“The riba of the Jahiliyyah is abolished; the first I abolish is our own — that of Abbas ibn Abd al-Muttalib.” (Muslim)

→ The end of **exploitation**.

(v) The rule of law — blood feuds ended

The first blood-claim abolished was that of **Ibn Rabi'ah ibn al-Harith** of his own clan (Muslim) — private revenge replaced by law.

(vi) Personal responsibility

✦ HADITH

أَلَا لَا يَجْنِي جَانٍ إِلَّا عَلَى نَفْسِهِ

“No offender is responsible except for his own offence.” (Al-Tirmidhi and Ibn Majah)

→ **No collective punishment**.

(vii) Inheritance, the weak and the Book

'Allah has given every rightful person his right — no bequest for an heir' (Abu Dawud); servants to be fed and clothed as their masters are (Ahmad); and 'I have left among you the Book of Allah' (Muslim) — **law above persons**.

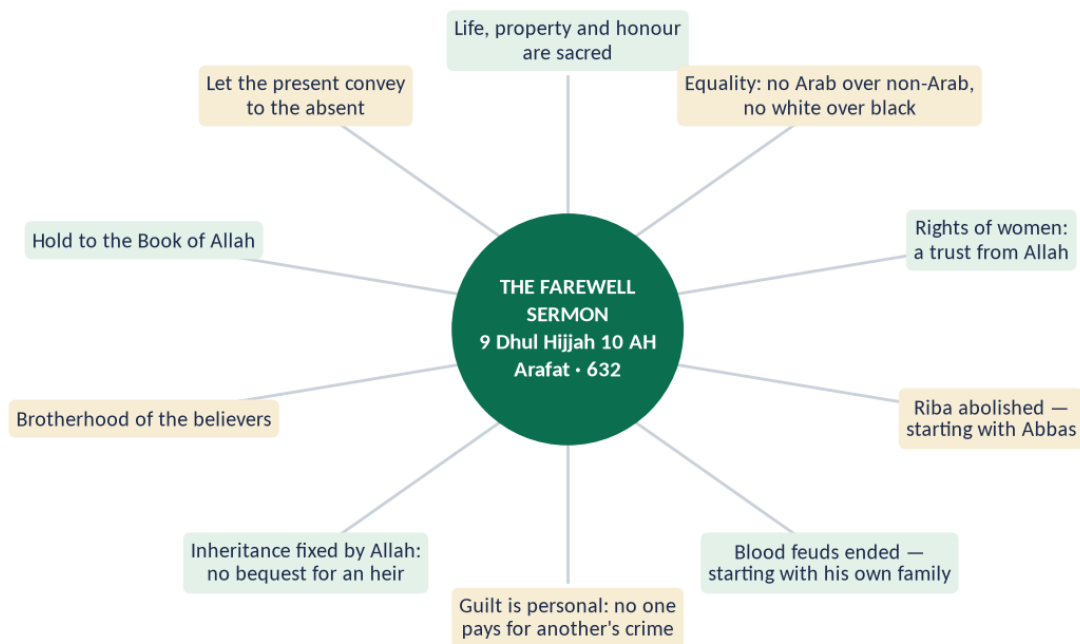


Figure 3 · The ten declarations of the Farewell Sermon.

(3) Why it is the 'basic document' of human rights

- **(a) The first:** about **580 years before Magna Carta (1215)**, **1,157 before the French Declaration (1789)**, **1,316 before the UDHR (1948)**.
- **(b) The most complete:** life, property, honour, equality, women, economy, justice, inheritance, the weak — in one short address.
- **(c) Universal:** 'O people' — addressed to **mankind**, not to barons or citizens of one state.

Right	Farewell Sermon (632)	UDHR (1948)
Life, security	'Your lives are sacred'	Article 3
Property	'Your property is sacred'	Article 17
Honour	'Your honour is sacred'	Article 12
Equality	'No Arab over a non-Arab...'	Articles 1, 2
Women	'Fear Allah concerning women'	Article 16
Personal liability	'No offender except for himself'	Article 11
Economic justice	Riba abolished	Articles 22–25

(4) Why it 'awakened the conscience' of mankind

(i) It tied rights to the fear of Allah

Every right came with 'fear Allah' — making the **conscience** the first guard of human rights. A law can be avoided; Allah cannot.

(ii) It was enforced first on the speaker's own family

Abbas's riba and Rabi'ah's blood were cancelled **first** — the conscience is moved when the leader applies the law to himself.

(iii) It made every listener a witness and a messenger

He asked, 'Have I not conveyed?' They said, 'Yes.' He raised his finger to the sky: 'O Allah, bear witness.'

✦ HADITH

لِيُبَلِّغَ الشَّاهِدُ الْغَائِبَ

"Let the one who is present convey to the one who is absent." (Al-Bukhari)

→ The sermon became the **responsibility of every generation**.

(5) Compared with the later charters

- **Magna Carta (1215)**: rights of **barons** against the king.
- **French Declaration (1789)**: rights of **citizens** of France, while colonies were ruled without rights.
- **UDHR (1948)**: universal, but a **non-binding declaration** made by 58 states while most of the world was colonised.
- **The Sermon**: universal, **moral and legal**, and **practised** by the speaker.

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Allama Muhammad Iqbal · The Reconstruction of Religious Thought in Islam

Iqbal saw in Islam a spiritual democracy — the equality, freedom and responsibility of all humans under one God — declared and lived by the Prophet ﷺ.

→ The sermon is that **spiritual democracy** in words.

(6) An honest note

The Sermon's power is weakened when Muslims themselves deny its rights — to women, minorities and the poor. Its message is a **standard** that judges Muslim societies first.

(7) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ إِنَّا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ مِنْ ذَكَرٍ وَأُنْثَىٰ وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتَقَىٰكُمْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ خَبِيرٌ﴾

"O mankind, indeed We have created you from male and female and made you peoples and tribes that you may know one another. Indeed, the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous of you. Indeed, Allah is Knowing and Acquainted." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ The most honoured of you is **the most righteous**.

The Farewell Sermon deserves to be called the basic document of human rights: it was **first, complete and universal**, and it **awakened the conscience** by joining every right to the fear of Allah and by enforcing it first on the speaker's own family. The world reached its words through centuries of struggle; the Muslim world must reach its practice.

Why this answer scores

- Both parts of the claim — '**basic document**' and '**awakening of conscience**' — have their own headings.

- Seven declarations are quoted with their **Arabic lines**, then matched with the UDHR.
- The comparison and the honest note show **critical discussion**.

Answer 2 · Short Notes: Human Rights in the Farewell Sermon; Social Justice in an Islamic Society (CSS 2023)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q8 · 20 marks (10 + 10)

Write notes on the following: (i) Human rights in the light of the Sermon of the Farewell Pilgrimage; (ii) Social justice in an Islamic society.

Two equal notes of 10 marks each.

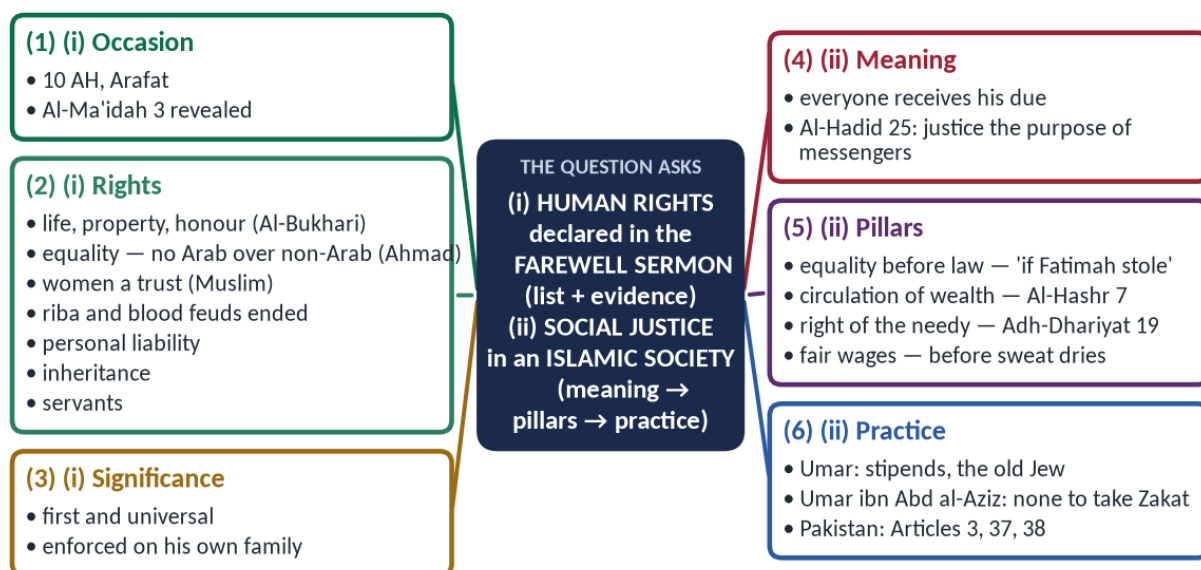


Figure 4 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- Two notes, **10 marks each** — equal space.
- **(i)** List the **rights** with their words from the Sermon; a short significance.
- **(ii)** Define social justice, then its **pillars** and **practice**.

The model answer

(i) Human rights in the light of the Sermon of the Farewell Pilgrimage

Occasion

Delivered on **9 Dhul Hijjah 10 AH (632)** at **Arafat** before more than a hundred thousand Companions, on the day Allah revealed: '**This day I have perfected your religion**' (Al-Ma'idah 3).

The rights declared

- **(a) Life, property and honour:**

★ HADITH

فَإِنَّ دِمَاءَكُمْ وَأَمْوَالَكُمْ وَأَعْرَاضَكُمْ عَلَيْكُمْ حَرَامٌ

"Your lives, property and honour are sacred to one another." (Al-Bukhari)

- **(b) Equality:** 'No Arab over a non-Arab, no white over black — except by taqwa' (Ahmad).
- **(c) Women:**

★ HADITH

فَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ فِي النِّسَاءِ، فَإِنَّكُمْ أَخَذْتُمُوهُنَّ بِأَمَانٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ

"Fear Allah concerning women; you took them as a trust from Allah." (Muslim)

- **(d) Economic justice:** riba abolished, first that of Abbas (Muslim).
- **(e) Rule of law:** blood feuds abolished, first that of Ibn Rabi'ah ibn al-Harith (Muslim).
- **(f) Personal responsibility:** 'No offender except for his own offence' (Al-Tirmidhi).
- **(g) Inheritance:** 'No bequest for an heir' (Abu Dawud).
- **(h) Servants:** fed and clothed as their masters.
- **(i) Brotherhood and the Book:** 'I have left among you the Book of Allah' (Muslim).

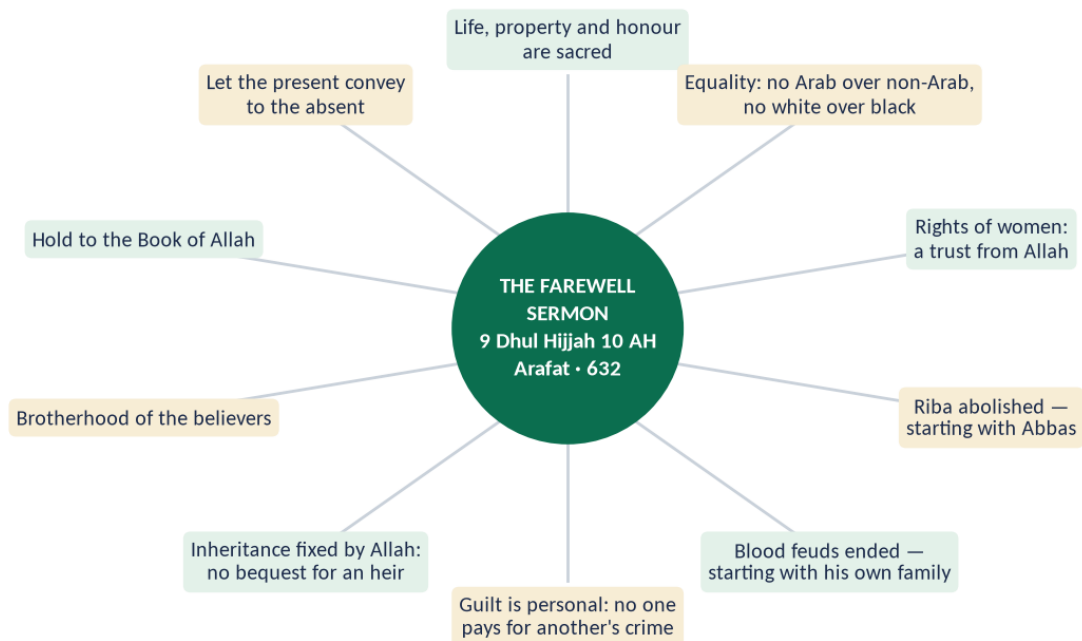


Figure 5 · The declarations of the Farewell Sermon.

Significance

The Sermon is the **first universal charter of human rights** — 580 years before Magna Carta — addressed to 'O people', and **enforced first on the Prophet's ﷺ own family**. It is the conscience behind every later declaration.

(ii) Social justice in an Islamic society

Meaning

Social justice — 'adl ijtimā'i (عَدْلُ اجْتِمَاعِي) — means that every member of society receives his due: equal treatment by law, fair opportunity, a share in wealth, and protection for the weak.

✦ QURAN

﴿لَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا رُسُلَنَا بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ وَأَنْزَلْنَا مَعَهُمُ الْكِتَابَ وَالْمِيزَانَ لِيَقُومَ النَّاسُ بِالْقِسْطِ...﴾

"We sent Our messengers with clear proofs and sent down with them the Book and the Balance, so that people may uphold justice." (Al-Hadid, Quran)

→ Allah sent His messengers with the Book and the Balance **so that people may uphold justice** — justice is the purpose of prophethood.

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّ اللَّهَ يَأْمُرُ بِالْعَدْلِ وَالْإِحْسَنِ وَإِيتَايِ ذِي الْقُرْبَىٰ وَيَنْهَىٰ عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ وَالْبَغْيِ يَعِظُكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَذَكَّرُونَ﴾

"Indeed, Allah orders justice and good conduct and giving to relatives and forbids immorality and bad conduct and oppression. He admonishes you that perhaps you will be reminded." (An-Nahl, Quran)

→ Allah commands **justice, excellence and giving to relatives**.

The pillars of social justice

• (a) Equality before law:

✦ HADITH

وَأَيْمُ اللَّهِ لَوْ أَنَّ فَاطِمَةَ بِنْتَ مُحَمَّدٍ سَرَقَتْ لَقَطَعْتُ يَدَهَا

"By Allah, if Fatimah daughter of Muhammad stole, I would cut her hand." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ No privilege for the powerful.

• (b) Circulation of wealth:

✦ QURAN

﴿... كَيْ لَا يَكُونَ دُولَةً بَيْنَ الْأَغْنِيَاءِ مِنْكُمْ...﴾

"... so that it does not circulate only among the rich among you." (Al-Hashr, Quran)

→ So that wealth does **not circulate only among the rich** — through Zakat, inheritance, and the ban on riba and hoarding.

- **(c) Right of the needy:** 'In their wealth is a right for the one who asks and the deprived' (Adh-Dhariyat 19).
- **(d) Dignity of labour:** 'Give the worker his wage before his sweat dries' (Ibn Majah).
- **(e) Equal opportunity:** Bilal, Salman and Usamah rose by merit, not birth.
- **(f) Accountable rulers:** the ruler is a servant — 'each of you is a shepherd' (Al-Bukhari).

Social justice in practice

- **Hazrat Umar (RA)** fixed stipends for every citizen, even newborns, and for a poor old Jew from the treasury (Abu Yusuf, *Kitab al-Kharaj*).
- Under **Umar ibn Abd al-Aziz** (717–720), Zakat collectors could find no one poor enough to take it.

Pakistan

The Constitution promises the elimination of exploitation (**Article 3**), social justice (**Article 37**) and the well-being of the people (**Article 38**); with about 40 percent below the poverty line, implementation — not principle — is the gap.

Why this answer scores

- **Equal space** for two 10-mark notes.
- Note (i) gives **the Sermon's own words** for each right.
- Note (ii) moves from **meaning** → **pillars** → **practice** → **Pakistan**.

Answer 3 · Human Respect and Dignity Irrespective of Colour, Race and Creed (CSS 2020)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2020 · Q7 · 20 marks

"Islam teaches the lesson of human respect and dignity irrespective of colour, race and creed". Discuss.

Dignity for all → then three headings: colour, race, creed — each with Quran, Hadith and a Sunnah example.

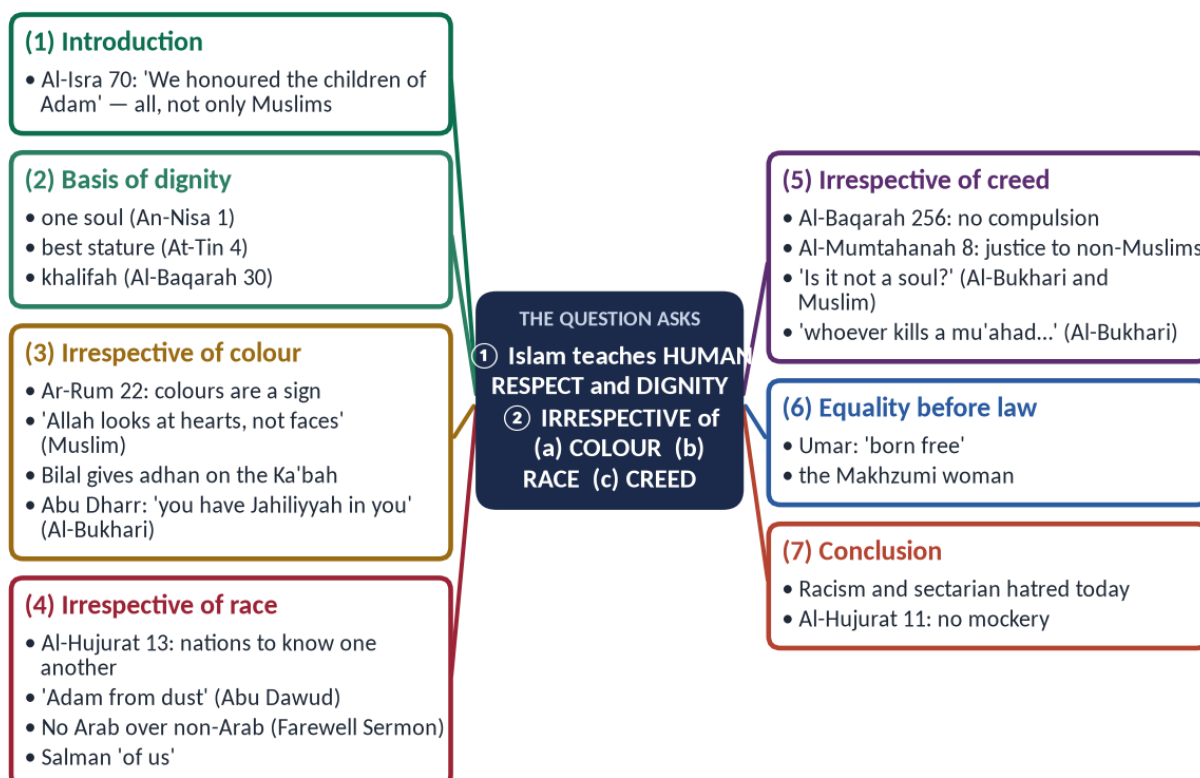


Figure 6 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Human respect and dignity'** = the Islamic basis of dignity for every human being.
- **'Irrespective of colour, race and creed'** = three separate headings — the **creed** limb is the one most candidates forget.
- **'Discuss'** = evidence plus practice, and the modern relevance.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ وَحَمَلْنَاهُمْ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ وَرَزَقْنَاهُمْ مِنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَفَضَّلْنَاهُمْ عَلَى كَثِيرٍ مِمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا تَفْضِيلًا﴾

"And We have certainly honored the children of Adam and carried them on the land and sea and provided for them of the good things and preferred them over much of what We have created, with [definite] preference."

(Al-Isra, Quran)

→ 'We have honoured the children of Adam' — not the Arabs, not the believers, but **all** the children of Adam.

In the seventh century, human worth was measured by tribe, colour, wealth and religion. Islam declared that dignity is **given by Allah to every human being** and cannot be taken away by colour, race or creed.

(2) The basis of human dignity

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً...﴾

"O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women." **(An-Nisa, Quran)**

→ All mankind was created **from one soul** — one family.

✦ QURAN

﴿لَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ فِي أَحْسَنِ تَقْوِيمٍ﴾

"We have certainly created man in the best of stature." **(At-Tin, Quran)**

→ 'We created man in the best of stature.'

✦ QURAN

﴿... إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً...﴾

"Indeed, I will make upon the earth a vicegerent (khalifah)." **(Al-Baqarah, Quran)**

→ Man is **Allah's vicegerent** (khalifah) on earth.

(3) Dignity irrespective of colour

✦ QURAN

﴿وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالَمِينَ﴾

“And of His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth and the diversity of your languages and your colors. Indeed in that are signs for those of knowledge.” (Ar-Rum, Quran)

→ The **diversity of your languages and colours** is a sign of Allah — a mark of His art, not of rank.

✦ HADITH

إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَنْظُرُ إِلَى صُورِكُمْ وَأَمْوَالِكُمْ، وَلَكِنْ يَنْظُرُ إِلَى قُلُوبِكُمْ وَأَعْمَالِكُمْ

“Allah does not look at your appearance or your wealth, but at your hearts and your deeds.” (Muslim)

- **Bilal (RA)**, a black former slave, was chosen to give the adhan **from the roof of the Ka'bah** on the day Makkah was conquered, while the Quraysh chiefs watched.
- When **Abu Dharr (RA)** taunted a man about his black mother, the Prophet ﷺ said:

✦ HADITH

إِنَّكَ امْرُؤٌ فِيكَ جَاهِلِيَّةٌ

“You are a man in whom there is still Jahiliyyah.” (Al-Bukhari)

→ Colour prejudice is **pre-Islamic ignorance**.

(4) Dignity irrespective of race

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ إِنَّا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ مِّن ذَكَرٍ وَأُنثَىٰ وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِندَ اللَّهِ أَتَقَىٰكُمْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ خَبِيرٌ﴾

“O mankind, indeed We have created you from male and female and made you peoples and tribes that you may know one another. Indeed, the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous of you. Indeed, Allah is Knowing and Acquainted.” (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ Nations and tribes were made **to know one another**; the most honoured is **the most righteous**.

✦ HADITH

النَّاسُ بَنُو آدَمَ، وَآدَمُ مِنْ تُرَابٍ

“People are the children of Adam, and Adam was from dust.” (Abu Dawud and Al-Tirmidhi)

✦ FROM THE SIRAH

لَا فَضْلَ لِعَرَبِيٍّ عَلَى عَجَمِيٍّ، وَلَا لِعَجَمِيٍّ عَلَى عَرَبِيٍّ ... إِلَّا بِالتَّقْوَىٰ

“No Arab has superiority over a non-Arab, nor a non-Arab over an Arab ... except by taqwa.” (Musnad Ahmad (the Farewell Sermon))

- **Salman (RA)** the Persian: 'Salman is one of us, the people of the house' (Al-Hakim).
- **Suhayb (RA)** the Roman and **Bilal (RA)** the Abyssinian stood with the Quraysh as equals.
- **Usamah ibn Zayd (RA)**, son of a freed slave, commanded an army that included senior Companions.

(5) Dignity irrespective of creed

✦ QURAN

﴿لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ الرُّشْدُ مِنَ الْغَيِّ...﴾

"There is no compulsion in religion; the right course has become clear from the wrong." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ No compulsion in religion.

✦ QURAN

﴿لَا يَنْهَىكُمُ اللَّهُ عَنِ الَّذِينَ لَمْ يُقَاتِلُوكُمْ فِي الدِّينِ وَلَمْ يُخْرِجُوكُم مِّن دِيَارِكُمْ أَن تَبَرُّوهُمْ وَنُقِصُوا إِلَيْهِمْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ يُحِبُّ الْمُقْسِطِينَ﴾

"Allah does not forbid you from those who do not fight you because of religion and do not expel you from your homes - from being righteous toward them and acting justly toward them. Indeed, Allah loves those who act justly." (Al-Mumtahanah, Quran)

→ Allah does not forbid **kindness and justice** to those who do not fight you.

✦ HADITH

أَلَيْسَتْ نَفْسًا

"Is it not a soul?" (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ He stood for a Jewish funeral.

✦ HADITH

مَنْ قَتَلَ مُعَاهِدًا لَمْ يَرِحْ رَائِحَةَ الْجَنَّةِ

"Whoever kills a non-Muslim under covenant will not smell the fragrance of Paradise." (Al-Bukhari)

- The **Christians of Najran** prayed in the Mosque of Madinah; their churches were protected by treaty.
- **Umar (RA)** gave a poor old Jew a stipend from the treasury.
- **Ali (RA)**, as Caliph, lost a case over his shield to a non-Muslim before **Qadi Shurayh**.

(6) Equality before the law — the practical test

When the governor's son struck an Egyptian commoner, **Umar (RA)** had the Egyptian strike back and said:

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Hazrat Umar Farooq (RA) · Second Rightly-Guided Caliph, to his governor of Egypt

"Since when have you enslaved people when their mothers bore them free?"

→ Dignity **before the law**, regardless of rank.

Dignity irrespective of colour, race and creed — the names only		
Colour	Race	Creed
Ar-Rum 22	Al-Hujurat 13	no compulsion
hearts, not faces	Adam from dust	Al-Mumtahanah 8
Bilal on the Ka'bah	no Arab over non-Arab	'is it not a soul?'
Abu Dharr: 'Jahiliyyah'	Salman, Suhayb, Usamah	mu'ahad
		Najran
		Ali's shield

Figure 7 · At a glance — dignity irrespective of colour, race and creed — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(7) The modern relevance

Racism in the West, caste in South Asia, ethnic and sectarian hatred in Muslim lands, and Islamophobia all deny this lesson. Pakistan's **Articles 25, 20 and 36** reflect it; our society must practise it — in how we treat the poor, other ethnic groups, other sects and minorities.

(8) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿... لَا يَسْخَرُ قَوْمٌ مِّن قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِّن نِّسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُنَّ خَيْرًا مِّنْهُنَّ ...﴾

"Let not a people ridicule another people — perhaps they are better than them; nor let women ridicule other women — perhaps they are better than them." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ Let no people **mock another people** — perhaps they are better than them.

Islam does not merely tolerate difference; it **honours the human being as such**. Colour is a sign of Allah's art, race a means of recognition, and creed a matter of free choice — none of them a reason to deny anyone respect. That is the lesson of the Quran, the Sunnah and the Rightly-Guided Caliphs, and the world still needs it.

Why this answer scores

- **Three headings — colour, race, creed** — exactly as the question lists them; creed is not forgotten.
- Each has **Quran → Hadith → Sunnah example**.
- The modern relevance section turns 'teaches the lesson' into a lesson for today.

Answer 4 · How Islam Highlights Human Dignity and Greatness (CSS 2024)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2024 · Q5 · 20 marks

How does Islam highlight human dignity and greatness? Discuss.

Headings = the ways Islam shows man's dignity and greatness, then how it protects them.

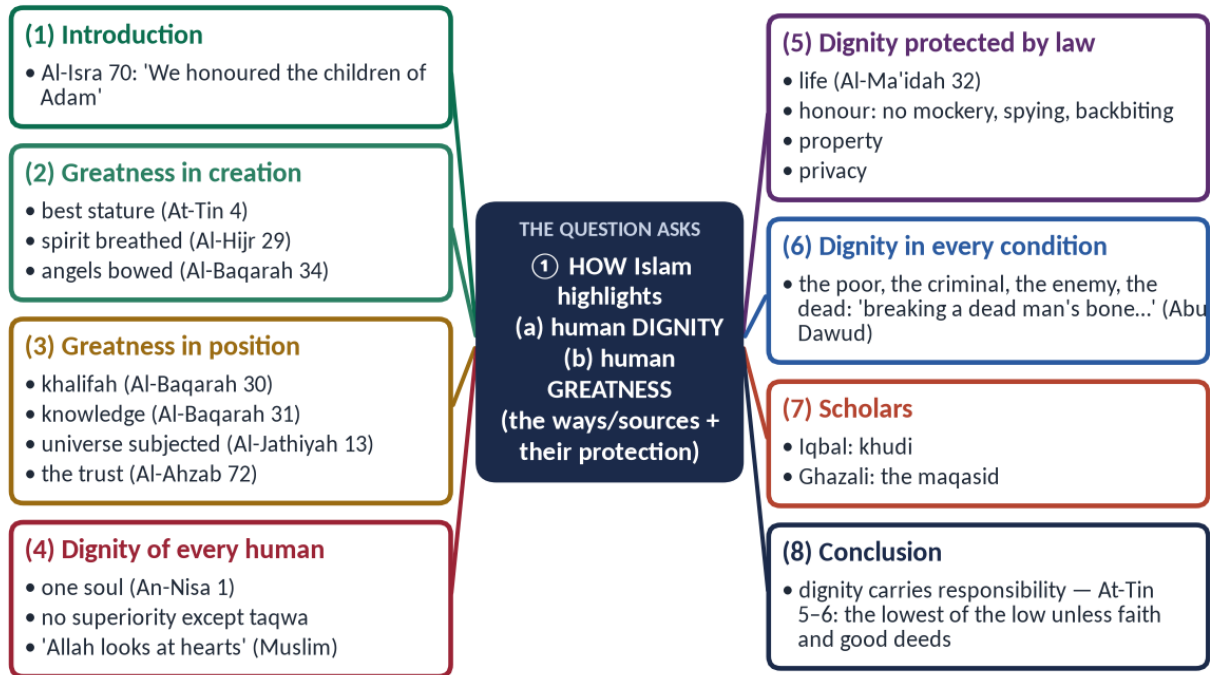


Figure 8 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'How'** = the **ways and sources** through which Islam shows human dignity — not only a statement that it does.
- **'Dignity'** (karamah, كَرَامَة) = honour due to every human; **'greatness'** = man's high position and potential.
- **'Discuss'** = add the protection of dignity in law and practice, and the responsibility that comes with it.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ وَحَمَلْنَاهُمْ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ وَرَزَقْنَاهُمْ مِنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَفَضَّلْنَاهُمْ عَلَى كَثِيرٍ مِمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا تَفْضِيلًا﴾

"And We have certainly honored the children of Adam and carried them on the land and sea and provided for them of the good things and preferred them over much of what We have created, with [definite] preference."

(Al-Isra, Quran)

→ 'We have honoured the children of Adam', carried them on land and sea, provided them with good things and preferred them over much of creation.

Philosophies have described man as a talking animal, a machine, or a product of chance. Islam describes him as the **honoured vicegerent of Allah**, created with purpose and entrusted with the earth. It highlights his dignity and greatness in his **creation**, his **position**, his **equality** and in the **laws** that protect him.

(2) Greatness in his creation

(i) The best form

✦ QURAN

﴿لَقَدْ خَلَقْنَا الْإِنْسَانَ فِي أَحْسَنِ تَقْوِيمٍ﴾

"We have certainly created man in the best of stature." **(At-Tin, Quran)**

→ 'We created man in the best of stature.'

(ii) The spirit of Allah

✦ QURAN

﴿فَإِذَا سَوَّيْتُهُ وَنَفَخْتُ فِيهِ مِنْ رُوحِي فَقَعُوا لَهُ سَاجِدِينَ﴾

"And when I have proportioned him and breathed into him of My [created] soul, then fall down to him in prostration." **(Al-Hijr, Quran)**

→ 'When I have proportioned him and **breathed into him of My spirit**, fall down to him in prostration.'

(iii) The angels bowed to him

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِذْ قُلْنَا لِلْمَلَائِكَةِ اسْجُدُوا لِآدَمَ فَسَجَدُوا إِلَّا إِبْلِيسَ أَبَىٰ وَاسْتَكْبَرَ وَكَانَ مِنَ الْكَافِرِينَ﴾

"And [mention] when We said to the angels, "Prostrate before Adam"; so they prostrated, except for Iblees. He refused and was arrogant and became of the disbelievers." **(Al-Baqarah, Quran)**

→ The angels were commanded to **prostrate to Adam** — honour above the angels.

(3) Greatness in his position and role

(i) Vicegerent on earth

✦ QURAN

﴿... إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً...﴾

"Indeed, I will make upon the earth a vicegerent (khalifah)." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ 'I will make upon the earth a vicegerent (khalifah).'

(ii) Knowledge — the basis of his rank

✦ QURAN

﴿وَعَلَّمَ آدَمَ الْأَسْمَاءَ كُلَّهَا ثُمَّ عَرَضَهُمْ عَلَى الْمَلَائِكَةِ فَقَالَ أَنْبِئُونِي بِأَسْمَاءِ هَؤُلَاءِ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ صَادِقِينَ﴾

"And He taught Adam the names - all of them. Then He showed them to the angels and said, "Inform Me of the names of these, if you are truthful." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ Allah **taught Adam the names** of all things, and the angels could not answer — knowledge made man superior.

(iii) Master of nature

✦ QURAN

﴿وَسَخَّرَ لَكُم مَّا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ جَمِيعًا مِّنْهُ إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ﴾

"And He has subjected to you whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on the earth - all from Him. Indeed in that are signs for a people who give thought." (Al-Jathiyah, Quran)

→ He has made **subject to you all that is in the heavens and the earth** — man is the master of nature, not its worshipper.

(iv) Bearer of the trust

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّا عَرَضْنَا الْأَمَانَةَ عَلَى السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَالْجِبَالِ فَأَبَيْنَ أَنْ يَحْمِلَهَا وَأَشْفَقْنَ مِنْهَا وَحَمَلَهَا الْإِنْسَنُ إِنَّهُ كَانَ ظَلُومًا جَهُولًا﴾

"Indeed, we offered the Trust to the heavens and the earth and the mountains, and they declined to bear it and feared it; but man [undertook to] bear it. Indeed, he was unjust and ignorant." (Al-Ahzab, Quran)

→ The heavens, the earth and the mountains refused the **trust (amanah)**; man accepted it — **free will and responsibility** are his greatness.

(4) Dignity of every human being — equality

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً

﴿...﴾

“O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ All created **from one soul** — no human is born lower than another.

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ إِنَّا خَلَقْنَكُمْ مِنْ ذَكَرٍ وَأُنْثَىٰ وَجَعَلْنَكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتَقَىٰكُمْ

﴿إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ خَبِيرٌ﴾

“O mankind, indeed We have created you from male and female and made you peoples and tribes that you may know one another. Indeed, the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous of you. Indeed, Allah is Knowing and Acquainted.” (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ Honour is by **taqwa**, not by race or wealth.

✦ HADITH

﴿إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَنْظُرُ إِلَى صُورِكُمْ وَأَمْوَالِكُمْ، وَلَكِنْ يَنْظُرُ إِلَى قُلُوبِكُمْ وَأَعْمَالِكُمْ﴾

“Allah does not look at your appearance or your wealth, but at your hearts and your deeds.” (Muslim)

Bilal the Abyssinian on the Ka'bah; Salman the Persian 'of the people of the house'; Umar to his governor: 'Since when have you enslaved people whose mothers bore them free?'

(5) Dignity protected by law

(i) Life

✦ QURAN

﴿... مَنْ قَتَلَ نَفْسًا بِغَيْرِ نَفْسٍ أَوْ فَسَادٍ فِي الْأَرْضِ فَكَأَنَّمَا قَتَلَ النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا وَمَنْ أَحْيَاهَا فَكَأَنَّمَا أَحْيَا

النَّاسَ جَمِيعًا...﴾

“Whoever kills a soul — unless for a soul or for corruption in the land — it is as if he had slain mankind entirely; and whoever saves one, it is as if he had saved mankind entirely.” (Al-Ma'idah, Quran)

→ Killing one innocent soul is **like killing all mankind**.

(ii) Honour and reputation

✦ QURAN

﴿... لَا يَسْخَرُ قَوْمٌ مِّن قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُونُوا خَيْرًا مِّنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِّن نِّسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَن يَكُنَّ خَيْرًا مِّنْهُنَّ ...﴾

"Let not a people ridicule another people — perhaps they are better than them; nor let women ridicule other women — perhaps they are better than them." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ No mocking, no insulting names.

✦ QURAN

﴿... أَجْتَنِبُوا كَثِيرًا مِّنَ الظَّنِّ إِنَّ بَعْضَ الظَّنِّ إِثْمٌ وَلَا تَجَسَّسُوا وَلَا يَغْتَبَ بَعْضُكُم بَعْضًا ...﴾

"Avoid much suspicion; indeed, some suspicion is sin. And do not spy, and do not backbite one another." (Al-Hujurat, Quran)

→ No suspicion, **no spying, no backbiting** — likened to eating a dead brother's flesh.

✦ HADITH

فَإِنَّ دِمَاءَكُمْ وَأَمْوَالَكُمْ وَأَعْرَاضَكُمْ عَلَيْكُمْ حَرَامٌ

"Your lives, your property and your honour are sacred." (Al-Bukhari)

→ The Farewell Sermon puts **honour** beside life and property.

(iii) Privacy and freedom

Entering homes without permission is forbidden (An-Nur 27); 'no compulsion in religion' (Al-Baqarah 256).

(6) Dignity in every condition

- **The poor:** charity 'without reminders or injury' (Al-Baqarah 264).
- **The servant:** 'Your servants are your brothers — feed them from what you eat' (Al-Bukhari).
- **The criminal:** the Prophet ﷺ forbade cursing a man punished for drinking (Al-Bukhari).
- **The enemy:** no mutilation (Muslim).
- **The dead:**

✦ HADITH

كَسْرُ عَظْمِ الْمَيِّتِ كَكَسْرِهِ حَيًّا

"Breaking the bone of a dead person is like breaking it while he is alive." (Abu Dawud)

→ Dignity **beyond death**; he stood for a Jewish funeral: 'Is it not a soul?'

How Islam highlights human dignity and greatness — the names only			
Creation	Position	Equality	Protection
best stature	khalifah	one soul	life
spirit breathed	knowledge	taqwa, not race	honour: no mockery, spying, backbiting
angels bowed	universe subjected	hearts, not faces	privacy
	the trust	'born free'	every condition — poor, servant, criminal, enemy, dead

Figure 9 · At a glance — how Islam highlights human dignity and greatness — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(7) The scholars

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Allama Muhammad Iqbal · Asrar-e-Khudi; Bal-e-Jibril

Iqbal's philosophy of **khudi** teaches that man, as the vicegerent of God, grows great by strengthening his self through faith, action and struggle — 'Khudi ko kar buland itna...'.
 → Greatness is a **potential to be developed**.

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Imam al-Ghazali · Al-Mustasfa

The Shari'ah protects five essentials — faith, life, intellect, lineage and property — the whole law is a shield around human dignity.
 → Dignity is the **aim of the law**.

(8) Dignity carries responsibility

✦ QURAN

﴿ثُمَّ رَدَدْنَاهُ أَسْفَلَ سَافِلِينَ إِلَّا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ فَلَهُمْ أَجْرٌ غَيْرُ مَمْنُونٍ﴾

"Then We return him to the lowest of the low. Except for those who believe and do righteous deeds, for they will have a reward uninterrupted." (At-Tin, Quran)

→ Then We return him to **the lowest of the low** — **except those who believe and do good deeds**.

Man's dignity is given; his greatness is **earned** through faith, knowledge and good deeds. The same human being can rise above the angels or fall below the animals.

(9) Conclusion

Islam highlights human dignity by the way man was **created**, the **position** he was given, the **equality** of all humans, and the **laws** that protect his life, honour and privacy — even after death. In an age of racism, exploitation and the degradation of human beings by war and poverty, this vision is the most needed message Islam has for the world.

Why this answer scores

- It answers '**how**' — the ways and sources — in clear headings.
- It separates **dignity** (given to all) and **greatness** (position and potential).
- The responsibility section (At-Tin 5–6) and the scholars add **depth**.

Answer 5 · Islam and the UDHR: A Comparative and Critical Analysis (CSS 2026)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q2 · 20 marks

Provide a comparative and critical analysis of the human rights granted by Islam with those enshrined in the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (UDHR).

Comparison first (agree / differ), then critique of both, then a balanced verdict.

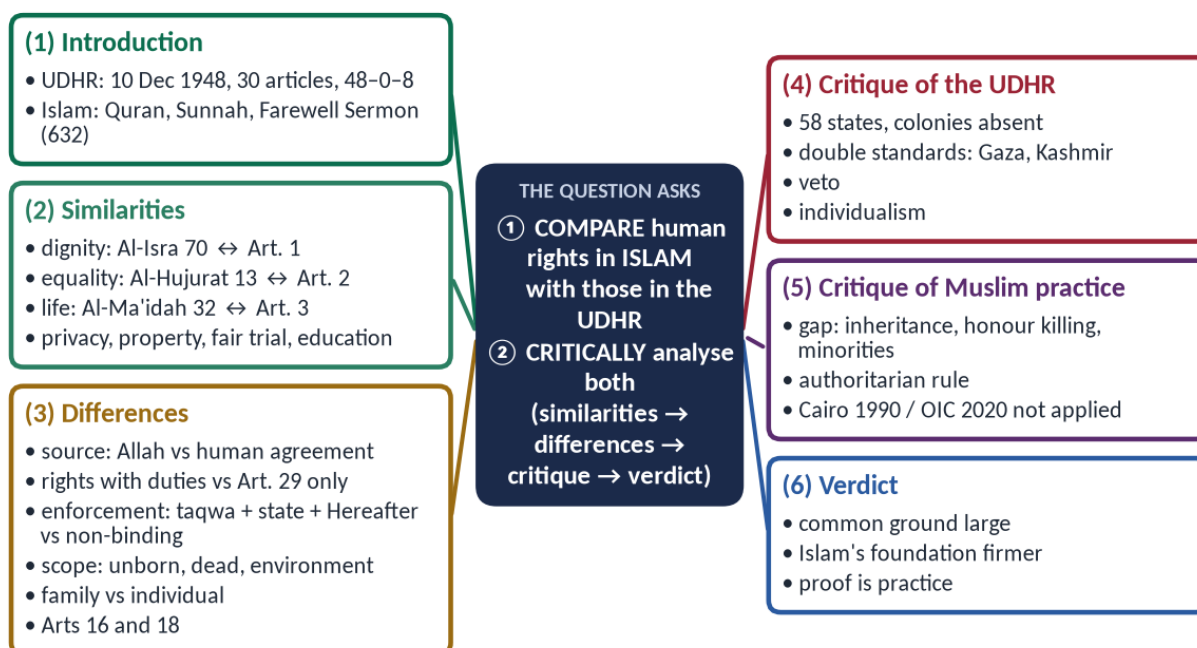


Figure 10 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

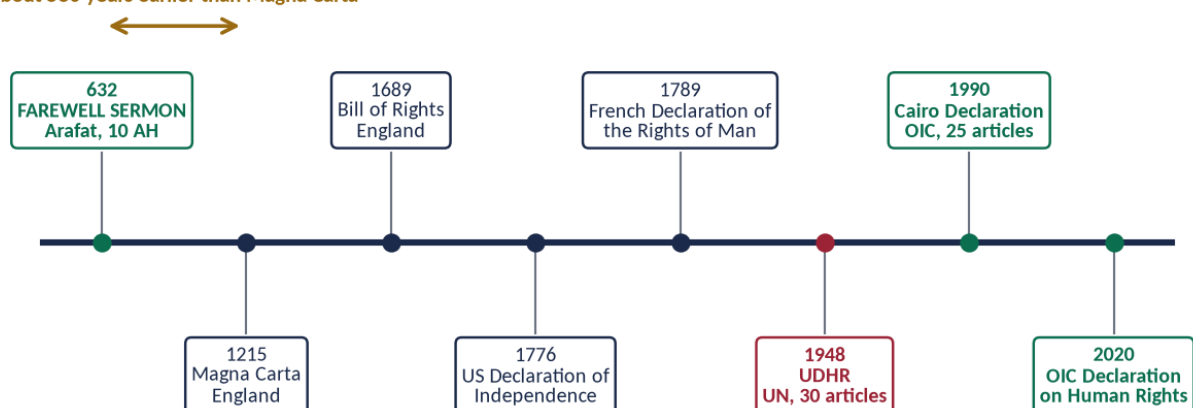
- 'Comparative' = similarities **and** differences, point by point.
- 'Critical' = judge the strengths and weaknesses of **both** — including Muslim practice.
- 'Human rights granted by Islam' vs 'enshrined in the UDHR' — use both the texts and their application.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

The **Universal Declaration of Human Rights** was adopted by the UN General Assembly on **10 December 1948** — a preamble and **30 articles**, passed **48-0 with 8 abstentions**; **Pakistan voted in favour**. Islam declared human rights **thirteen centuries earlier**, in the Quran, the Sunnah, the Charter of Madinah and the **Farewell Sermon** (632). Muslim states restated them in the **Cairo Declaration** (1990) and the **OIC Declaration on Human Rights** (2020).

about 580 years earlier than Magna Carta



The Farewell Sermon was addressed to all mankind ('O people'), not to a king's barons or one nation's citizens.

Figure 11 · From the Farewell Sermon to the UDHR and the OIC declarations.

(2) The similarities

Right	Islam	UDHR
Dignity	Al-Isra 70	Preamble; Article 1
Equality	Al-Hujurat 13; Farewell Sermon	Articles 1, 2, 7
Life and security	Al-Ma'idah 32	Article 3
No torture	Ban on mutilation (Muslim)	Article 5
Fair trial	Al-Hujurat 6; 'the burden of proof is on the claimant' (Al-Tirmidhi)	Articles 10, 11
Privacy	An-Nur 27; Al-Hujurat 12	Article 12
Asylum	At-Tawbah 6	Article 14
Property	An-Nisa 29	Article 17
Work and fair wage	'Wage before sweat dries' (Ibn Majah)	Article 23
Education	'Seeking knowledge is obligatory' (Ibn Majah)	Article 26

On **most** rights, Islam and the UDHR **agree**.

(3) The differences

(i) Source

- **UDHR:** human agreement; what states grant, states can change.
- **Islam: Allah** — rights cannot be cancelled by any ruler or majority.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ وَحَمَلْنَهُمْ فِي الْوَبَرِ وَالْبَحْرِ وَرَزَقْنَهُمْ مِنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَفَضَّلْنَاهُمْ عَلَى كَثِيرٍ مِمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا تَفْضِيلًا﴾

"And We have certainly honored the children of Adam and carried them on the land and sea and provided for them of the good things and preferred them over much of what We have created, with [definite] preference."

(Al-Isra, Quran)

→ Dignity comes from Allah: 'We have honoured the children of Adam.'

(ii) Rights and duties

- **UDHR:** duties appear only in **Article 29**.
- **Islam:** every right is someone's **duty** — parents and children, husband and wife, ruler and ruled.

(iii) Enforcement

- **UDHR:** a **non-binding declaration**; enforcement depends on states and the Security Council, where five powers hold a **veto**.
- **Islam:** conscience (**taqwa**), the **state** and the **Hereafter** — the rights of people are not forgiven until the wronged forgive.

(iv) Scope

- **Islam** also protects the **unborn**, the **dead** ('breaking a dead man's bone is like breaking it alive' — Abu Dawud), **animals**, the **environment** and **future generations**.

(v) Individual and family

- **UDHR:** centred on the **individual**.
- **Islam:** the individual **within family and society**; the family is protected as sacred.

(vi) Limits of freedom

- **UDHR:** limited by law, public order and morality (Article 29(2)).
- **Islam:** freedom within the **limits of Allah** — no freedom to spread indecency, blasphemy or harm oneself.

(vii) Points of tension

Many Muslim states made **reservations** on **Article 16** (marriage without religious limitation) and **Article 18** (freedom to change religion), because marriage and apostasy fall under Islamic family and public law — while Islam affirms that there is **no compulsion** in accepting faith.

(4) Critical analysis of the UDHR and its practice

- **(a) Not truly universal in origin:** 58 UN members in 1948; most of Asia and Africa were **colonies** with no voice.
- **(b) Double standards:** rights enforced selectively — **Palestine, Gaza, Kashmir** ignored.
- **(c) The veto** blocks action on violations by powerful states.
- **(d) Individualism** without moral limits has weakened the family.
- **(e) Rights without duties** encourage a culture of claims.

(5) Critical analysis of Muslim practice

- **(a) The gap:** denial of women's inheritance, honour killings, forced marriage, child labour, mistreatment of minorities, torture in custody — all **against Islam**.
- **(b) Authoritarian rule** denies 'a word of justice before a tyrant ruler'.
- **(c) The Cairo (1990) and OIC (2020) declarations** are **weakly implemented**.

PAKISTAN · BOTH STANDARDS IN ONE CONSTITUTION

Pakistan's **Fundamental Rights (Articles 8–28)** reflect the UDHR; the **Objectives Resolution** and **Article 227** tie laws to the Quran and Sunnah. The country's record — on women, minorities and enforced disappearances — is judged by **both** standards.

Islam and the UDHR — the names only		
Agree	Differ	Critique
dignity	source	UDHR: 58 states, colonies absent
equality	duties	double standards
life	enforcement	veto
no torture	scope	individualism — Muslims: gap in practice
fair trial	family	authoritarianism
privacy	limits	OIC weak
asylum	Articles 16, 18	
property		
work		
education		

Figure 12 · At a glance — islam and the UDHR — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(6) Verdict and conclusion

★ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا كُونُوا قَوَّامِينَ بِالْقِسْطِ شُهَدَاءَ لِلَّهِ وَلَوْ عَلَىٰ أَنْفُسِكُمْ أَوِ الْوَالِدَيْنِ وَالْأَقْرَبِينَ ...﴾

"O you who believe, stand firmly for justice, as witnesses for Allah, even if it be against yourselves, your parents or your relatives." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ 'Stand firm for justice, as witnesses for Allah, even against yourselves.'

The UDHR is a great human achievement and agrees with Islam on most rights. Islam gives them a **firmer foundation** (Allah), a **fuller scope**, a **balance of rights and duties** and a **moral enforcement** no declaration can supply. But neither text protects anyone by itself: the UDHR is weakened by double standards, and the Islamic claim by Muslim practice. The strongest Muslim answer to the UDHR is not a better document — it is **better practice**.

Why this answer scores

- **Comparative:** a ten-row table of similarities and seven headed differences.
- **Critical:** critiques of **both** the UDHR and Muslim practice — the balance examiners reward.
- Hard facts: 1948, 30 articles, 48–0–8, 58 states, Articles 16, 18, 29.

Answer 6 · Human Rights in Islamic Thought, with the Status of Women (CSS 2022)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2022 · Q2 · 20 marks

Explain the concept of Human Rights in Islamic thought in specification of "Status of Women in Islam".

Short concept section, then the main body on women's status as human rights.

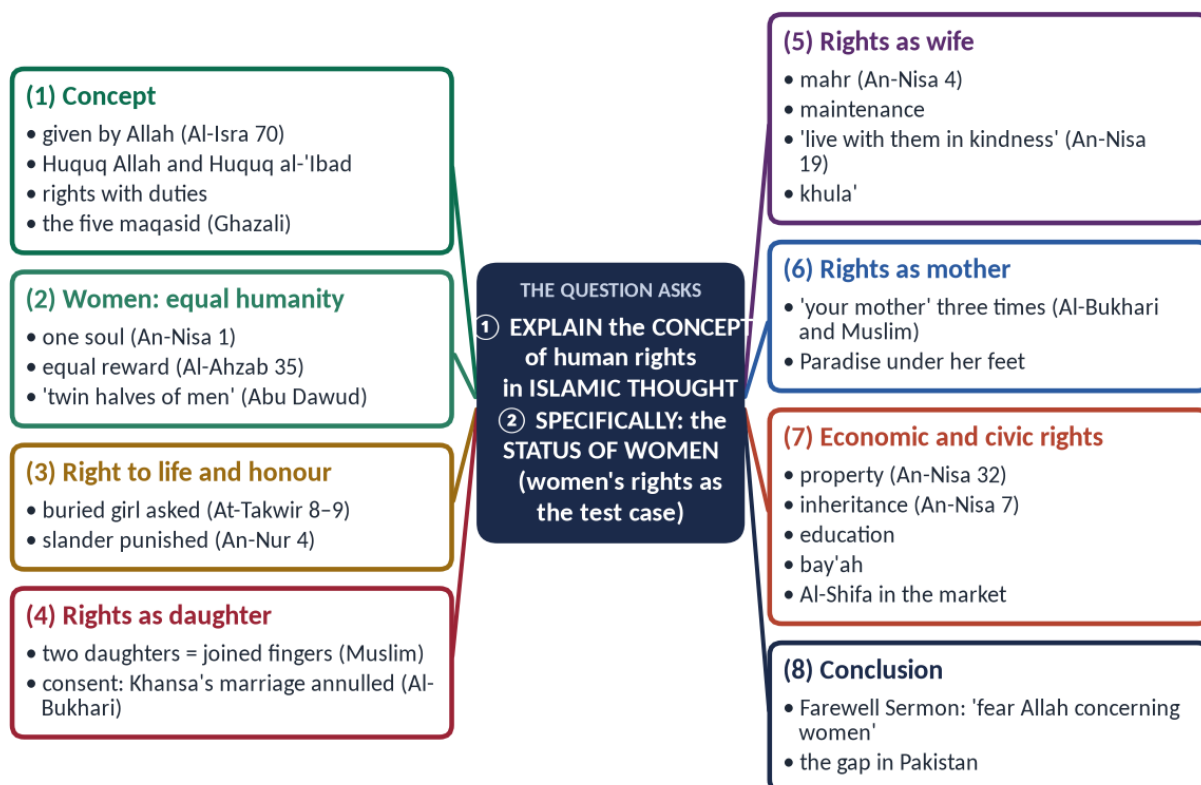


Figure 13 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Concept of human rights in Islamic thought'** — a short, clear framework: source, kinds, features, maqasid.
- **'In specification of the status of women'** — the main body: women's rights as **human rights**.
- Give roughly **one-third** to the concept and **two-thirds** to women.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ وَحَمَلْنَاهُمْ فِي الْبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ وَرَزَقْنَاهُمْ مِّنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَفَضَّلْنَاهُمْ عَلَى كَثِيرٍ مِّمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا تَفْضِيلًا﴾

"And We have certainly honored the children of Adam and carried them on the land and sea and provided for them of the good things and preferred them over much of what We have created, with [definite] preference."

(Al-Isra, Quran)

→ 'We have honoured the children of Adam' — dignity given to every human being, man or woman.

In Islamic thought, human rights are not a gift of states but a **trust from Allah**. The clearest test of any human-rights system is how it treats **women** — and here Islam made one of the greatest reforms in history.

(2) The concept of human rights in Islamic thought

(i) Source and nature

Rights are **given by Allah** through the Quran and Sunnah; they are **permanent, universal** and **joined with duties**.

(ii) Two kinds of rights

Huquq Allah (حُقوقُ اللَّهِ) and **Huquq al-'Ibad** (حُقوقُ الْعِبَادِ) — the rights of people are not forgiven until the wronged person forgives.

(iii) The framework — the Maqasid al-Shari'ah

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Imam al-Ghazali · Al-Mustasfa

The Shari'ah aims to protect five essentials — faith, life, intellect, lineage and property.

→ Every human right falls under one of these.

(iv) The charter

The **Farewell Sermon**: 'Your lives, property and honour are sacred' (Al-Bukhari).

(3) The status of women as human beings

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً...﴾

"O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Men and women were created **from one soul**.

✦ QURAN

﴿إِنَّ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَالْمُسْلِمَاتِ وَالْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتِ وَالْقَنَاتِ وَالْقَنَاتِ وَالصَّادِقِينَ وَالصَّادِقَاتِ وَالصَّابِرِينَ وَالصَّابِرَاتِ وَالْخَاشِعِينَ وَالْخَاشِعَاتِ وَالْمُتَصَدِّقِينَ وَالْمُتَصَدِّقَاتِ وَالصَّانِمِينَ وَالصَّانِمَاتِ وَالْحَفِظِينَ وَالْحَفِظَاتِ وَالذَّكِرِينَ وَالذَّكِرَاتِ أَعَدَّ اللَّهُ لَهُمْ مَغْفِرَةً وَأَجْرًا عَظِيمًا﴾

"Indeed, the Muslim men and Muslim women, the believing men and believing women, the obedient men and obedient women, the truthful men and truthful women, the patient men and patient women, the humble men and humble women, the charitable men and charitable women, the fasting men and fasting women, the men who guard their private parts and the women who do so, and the men who remember Allah often and the women who do so - for them Allah has prepared forgiveness and a great reward." (Al-Ahzab, Quran)

→ The **same forgiveness and great reward** for believing men and women.

✦ HADITH

إِنَّمَا النِّسَاءُ شَقَائِقُ الرِّجَالِ

"Women are the twin halves of men." (Abu Dawud and Al-Tirmidhi)

→ **Equal in humanity and dignity.**

Before Islam, girls were buried alive and women were inherited like property; Islam made them **persons with rights**.

(4) The rights of women

(i) Right to life and honour

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِذَا الْمَوْءِدَةُ سُئِلَتْ ﴿بِأَيِّ ذَنْبٍ قُتِلَتْ﴾﴾

"And when the girl [who was] buried alive is asked. For what sin she was killed." (At-Takwir, Quran)

→ The girl buried alive will be asked for what sin she was killed.

A false accusation against a chaste woman carries **eighty lashes** (An-Nur 4).

(ii) Rights as a daughter

✦ HADITH

مَنْ عَالَ جَارَتَيْنِ حَتَّى تَبْلُغَا، جَاءَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ أَنَا وَهُوَ — وَضَمَّ أَصَابِعَهُ

"Whoever raises two daughters until they grow up will be with me on the Day of Resurrection like this — and he joined his fingers." (Muslim)

Consent in marriage: when **Khansa bint Khidam** was married against her will, the Prophet ﷺ annulled it (Al-Bukhari).

(iii) Rights as a wife

✦ QURAN

﴿وَأَتُوا النِّسَاءَ صَدُقَتِهِنَّ نِحْلَةً فَإِنْ طِبَّنَ لَكُمْ عَنْ شَيْءٍ مِنْهُ نَفْسًا فَكُلُوهُ هَنِيئًا مَرِيًّا﴾

"And give the women [upon marriage] their [bridal] gifts graciously. But if they give up willingly to you anything of it, then take it in satisfaction and ease." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Give women their **mahr** as a free gift.

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ...﴾

"And live with them in kindness." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ 'Live with them in kindness.'

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَلَهُنَّ مِثْلُ الَّذِي عَلِمْنَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَلِلرِّجَالِ عَلِيمٌ دَرَجَةً...﴾

"And women have rights similar to their obligations, according to what is reasonable; and men have a degree over them." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ Women have **rights like their obligations**, according to what is reasonable.

Maintenance by the husband; the right to **khula'** (the wife of Thabit ibn Qays — Al-Bukhari).

(iv) Rights as a mother

✦ HADITH

أُمُّكَ، ثُمَّ أُمُّكَ، ثُمَّ أُمُّكَ، ثُمَّ أَبُوكَ

"Your mother, then your mother, then your mother, then your father." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

(v) Economic rights

✦ QURAN

﴿...لِلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِمَّا كَسَبُوا وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِمَّا كَسَبْنَ...﴾

"For men is a share of what they have earned, and for women is a share of what they have earned." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For women is a **share of what they have earned**.

✦ QURAN

﴿لِّلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ مِمَّا قَلَّ مِنْهُ أَوْ كَثُرَ نَصِيبًا مَّفْرُوضًا﴾

“For men is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, and for women is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, be it little or much - an obligatory share.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For women is a share of inheritance — **little or much, an obligatory share.**

(vi) Education and civic life

Knowledge obligatory on every Muslim (Ibn Majah); Hazrat Aishah (RA) taught the senior Companions; women gave the **bay'ah** (Al-Mumtahanah 12); **Al-Shifa bint Abdullah** supervised the market under Umar (RA).

DAUGHTER	WIFE	MOTHER	CITIZEN
right to life (At-Takwir)	mahr — hers alone	three times the father's right (Al-Bukhari)	equal reward (Al-Ahzab 35)
equal love and care	maintenance (nafaqah)	Paradise under her feet	education and work
education	kind treatment (An-Nisa 19)	maintenance by children	trade and property
consent in marriage	khula; fair divorce	inheritance: one-sixth	opinion and consultation
inheritance	own property and name	honour in old age	protection of honour

Figure 14 · The rights of the woman as daughter, wife, mother and citizen.

(5) The gap in practice — Pakistan

Denial of inheritance, forced marriage, honour killing and low female literacy come from **custom**, not Islam. Pakistani law now punishes them — the **2011** Anti-Women Practices Act, the **2016** honour-killing law, the **2020** property-rights Act — and the Constitution guarantees equality (**Article 25**) and women's participation (**Article 34**).

(6) Conclusion

✦ HADITH

فَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ فِي النِّسَاءِ، فَإِنَّكُمْ أَخَذْتُمُوهُنَّ بِأَمَانٍ مِنَ اللَّهِ

“Fear Allah concerning women; you have taken them as a trust from Allah.” (Muslim)

→ The Farewell Sermon's word on women.

Human rights in Islamic thought are divine, balanced and enforced by conscience; the status of women shows this concept at its best — equal humanity, protected life and honour, economic independence and respect at every stage of life. The task today is to close the gap between this teaching and Muslim practice.

Why this answer scores

- The **concept** is explained briefly and clearly; **women** receive the main weight, as 'in specification of demands.
- Women's rights are organised by **life stage and kind** — easy to follow and mark.
- The Pakistan gap shows honesty.

Answer 7 · Islam Provides Better Rights to Men and Women than All Other Religions (CSS 2021)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2021 · Q3 · 20 marks

Islam provides better rights to men and women than all other religions. Explore with arguments.

Compare laws and historical practice respectfully; cover both men and women.

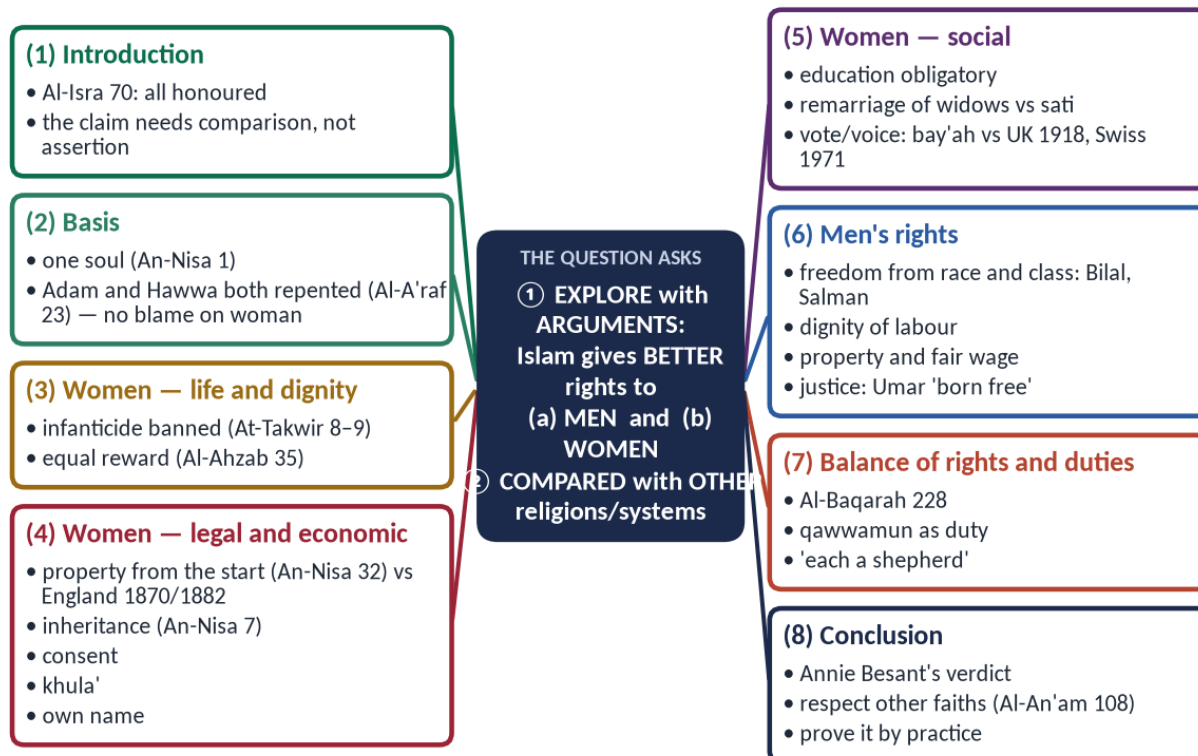


Figure 15 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Explore with arguments'** = a reasoned comparison, with evidence.
- **'Men and women'** — both, not women only.
- **'Other religions'** — compare **laws and historical practices** with respect; do not mock scriptures or founders.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

✦ QURAN

﴿وَلَقَدْ كَرَّمْنَا بَنِي آدَمَ وَحَمَلْنَهُمْ فِي الْوَبَرِّ وَالْبَحْرِ وَرَزَقْنَهُمْ مِنَ الطَّيِّبَاتِ وَفَضَّلْنَاهُمْ عَلَى كَثِيرٍ مِمَّنْ خَلَقْنَا تَفْضِيلًا﴾

"And We have certainly honored the children of Adam and carried them on the land and sea and provided for them of the good things and preferred them over much of what We have created, with [definite] preference."

(Al-Isra, Quran)

→ 'We have honoured the children of Adam.'

The claim that Islam gives better rights than other religions can be proved only by **comparison** — of what Islam established in the seventh century with the laws and customs of other religious civilisations, many of which changed only in the last two centuries. The comparison below is made with respect, as the Quran commands (Al-An'am 108).

(2) The basis — one humanity, no blame on woman

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً...﴾

"O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ All created **from one soul** and its mate.

✦ QURAN

﴿قَالَا رَبَّنَا ظَلَمْنَا أَنْفُسَنَا وَإِنْ لَمْ تَغْفِرْ لَنَا وَتَرْحَمْنَا لَنَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْخَاسِرِينَ﴾

"They said, 'Our Lord, we have wronged ourselves, and if You do not forgive us and have mercy upon us, we will surely be among the losers.'" (Al-A'raf, Quran)

→ Adam and Hawwa **both** said: 'Our Lord, we have wronged ourselves' — **both** repented and were forgiven.

Islam does not blame woman for the fall of man — a view that shaped the treatment of women in many societies.

(3) Better rights for women — the comparison

Right	Islam (7th century)	Elsewhere
Life	Burial of girls banned (At-Takwir 8–9)	Infanticide practised in several ancient societies
Spiritual equality	Same reward (Al-Ahzab 35)	Women excluded from priesthood and many rites
Consent to marriage	Required; forced marriage annulled (Al-Bukhari)	Arranged without consent widely

Right	Islam (7th century)	Elsewhere
Own property	From the start (An-Nisa 32)	England: Married Women's Property Acts, 1870 and 1882
Inheritance	Fixed share (An-Nisa 7, 11)	Excluded or reduced in many laws until modern times
Divorce	Khula' for the wife (Al-Baqarah 229)	Nearly impossible in many systems until the 20th century
Widow remarriage	Allowed; the Prophet ﷺ married widows	Sati in India (abolished 1829); remarriage barred
Education	Obligatory for every Muslim (Ibn Majah)	Universities opened to women mainly in the 19th century
Public voice	Women gave the bay'ah (Al-Mumtahanah 12)	Vote: UK 1918/1928; USA 1920; Switzerland 1971
Own name	Keeps her father's name	Takes the husband's name by custom or law in many places

✦ QURAN

﴿لِّلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ مِمَّا قَلَّ مِنْهُ أَوْ كَثُرَ نَصِيبًا مَّفْرُوضًا﴾

"For men is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, and for women is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, be it little or much - an obligatory share." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For women is a share of what parents and relatives leave — **little or much, an obligatory share.**

✦ HADITH

أُمُّكَ، ثُمَّ أُمُّكَ، ثُمَّ أُمُّكَ، ثُمَّ أَبُوكَ

"Your mother, then your mother, then your mother, then your father." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ The **mother** placed above the father three times.

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Annie Besant · The Life and Teachings of Muhammad (1932)

Besant noted that the Muslim woman held legal rights over her property from the beginning, and judged her in this respect freer under Islamic law than women in the West of her time.

→ A **Western reformer's** verdict.

(4) Better rights for men

(i) Freedom from racial and class hierarchy

Where caste and aristocracy fixed a man's worth at birth, Islam declared: 'No Arab over a non-Arab ... except by taqwa' (Ahmad). **Bilal** the Abyssinian gave the adhan on the Ka'bah; **Salman** the Persian was 'of the people of the house'.

(ii) Dignity of labour and fair wages

★ HADITH

أَعْطُوا الْأَجِيرَ أَجْرَهُ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَجِفَّ عَرَقُهُ

"Give the worker his wage before his sweat dries." (Ibn Majah)

(iii) Equality before the law

Umar (RA) to his governor, whose son had struck an Egyptian commoner: 'Since when have you enslaved people whose mothers bore them free?'

(iv) Freedom of conscience and expression

★ QURAN

﴿لَا إِكْرَاهَ فِي الدِّينِ قَدْ تَبَيَّنَ الرُّشْدُ مِنَ الْغَيِّ...﴾

"There is no compulsion in religion; the right course has become clear from the wrong." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ No compulsion in religion.

'The best jihad is a word of justice before a tyrant ruler' (Abu Dawud) — the right to speak truth to power.

(v) Freedom from priestly control

No priesthood stands between man and Allah; every man and woman prays directly to Him (Al-Baqarah 186).

(5) The balance of rights and duties

★ QURAN

﴿... وَلَهُنَّ مِثْلُ الَّذِي عَلِمْنَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَلِلرِّجَالِ عَلَىٰ هُنَّ دَرَجَةٌ...﴾

"And women have rights similar to their obligations, according to what is reasonable; and men have a degree over them." (Al-Baqarah, Quran)

→ Women have **rights like their obligations** — rights on both sides.

Men are **qawwamun** (An-Nisa 34) — a **duty** to protect and maintain, balanced by the wife's rights to mahr, maintenance and kindness. 'Each of you is a shepherd and each is responsible for his flock' (Al-Bukhari).

Better rights for men and women — the names only		
Women	Men	Balance
life	no race or class rank	rights like obligations
equal reward	fair wage	qawwamun as duty
consent	equality before law	each a shepherd
property (vs 1870/1882)	conscience and speech	
inheritance	no priesthood	
khula'		
widow remarriage (vs sati)		
education		
bay'ah (vs vote 1918–1971)		

Figure 16 · At a glance — better rights for men and women — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(6) An honest limit

Rights given in the text are not always given in practice: denial of inheritance and forced marriage in Muslim societies are **custom**, not Islam. The argument for Islam's superiority is strongest when Muslims **live it**.

(7) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿مَنْ عَمِلَ صَالِحًا مِّن ذَكَرٍ أَوْ أُنْثَىٰ وَهُوَ مُؤْمِنٌ فَلَنُحْيِيَنَّهٗ حَيٰوةً طَيِّبَةً وَلَنَجْزِيَنَّهُمْ أَجْرَهُم بِأَحْسَنِ مَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ﴾

“Whoever does righteousness, whether male or female, while he is a believer - We will surely cause him to live a good life, and We will surely give them their reward [in the Hereafter] according to the best of what they used to do.” (An-Nahl, Quran)

→ Whoever does good, **male or female**, while a believer — We will give him a good life.

Compared with the laws and customs of other religious civilisations, Islam gave **women** life, property, inheritance, consent, divorce and education centuries earlier, and gave **men** freedom from caste, dignity of labour, equality before the law and direct access to God. It did so with a **balance of rights and duties** that protects the family. That is why the claim stands — provided Muslims prove it by practice.

Why this answer scores

- It **compares** — a ten-row table with dates — instead of merely claiming.
- It covers **men and women**, as the question says.
- It is **respectful** of other faiths and **honest** about Muslim practice.

Answer 8 · The Rights of Daughters in Islam and Their Denial by Muslims Today (CSS 2023)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q4 · 20 marks

Elaborate the rights of daughters granted by Islam and how these are denied by Muslims in the contemporary world?

Two limbs: rights (with evidence) → denial (with reality, ruling and remedy).

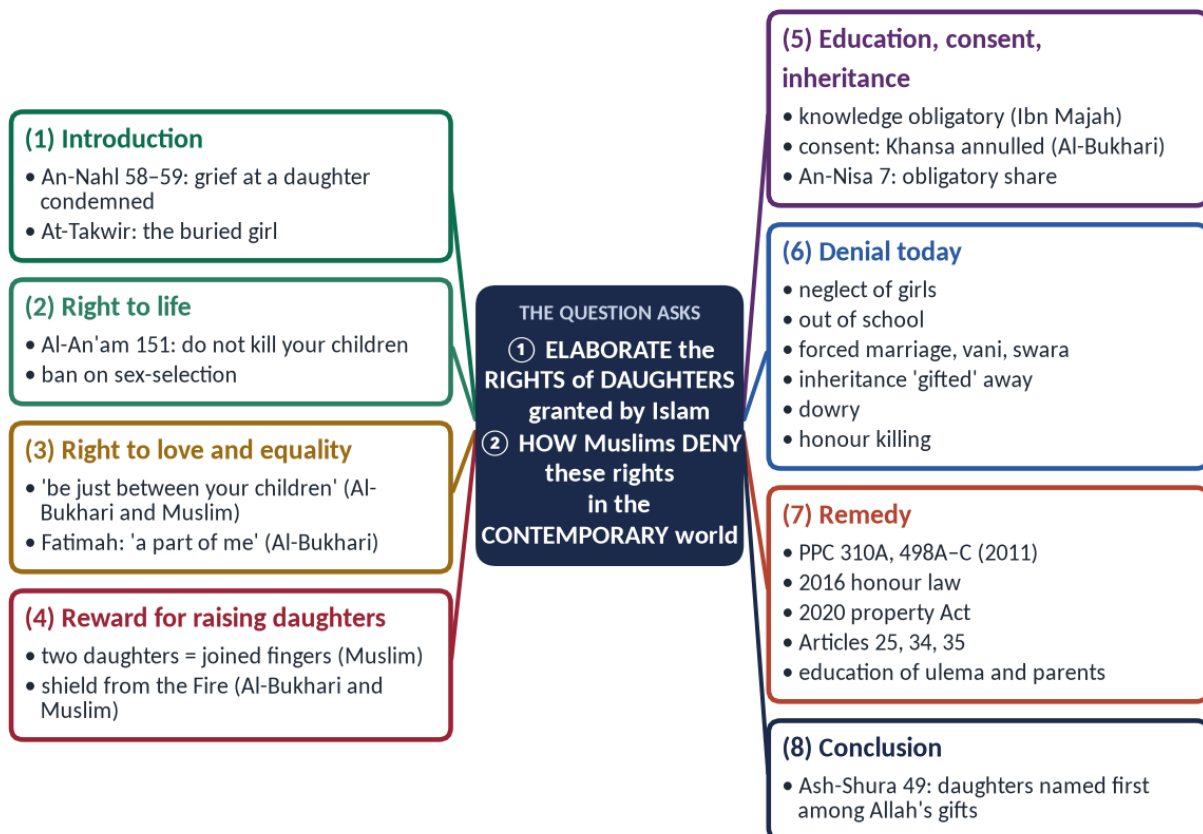


Figure 17 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Elaborate the rights'** = each right with its Quranic or Prophetic evidence.
- **'How these are denied by Muslims'** = honest description of practices — with facts.
- **'Contemporary world'** = today, especially Pakistan and South Asia.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِذَا بُشِّرَ أَحَدُهُم بِالْأُنثَىٰ ظَلَّ وَجْهُهُ مُسْوَدًّا وَهُوَ كَظِيمٌ ﴿١﴾ يَتَوَرَّى مِنَ الْقَوْمِ مِن سُوءِ مَا بُشِّرَ بِهِ ۚ أَيُمْسِكُهُ عَلَىٰ هُونٍ أَمْ يَدُسُّهُ فِي التُّرَابِ ۗ أَلَا سَاءَ مَا يَحْكُمُونَ﴾

"And when one of them is informed of [the birth of] a female, his face becomes dark, and he suppresses grief. He hides himself from the people because of the ill of which he has been informed. Should he keep it in humiliation or bury it in the ground? Unquestionably, evil is what they decide." (An-Nahl, Quran)

→ When one of them was told of the birth of a girl, **his face darkened**; should he keep her in humiliation or **bury her in the dust**? Evil is their judgement.

Islam came to a society that buried daughters alive. It turned the daughter from a source of shame into a **gift of Allah and a path to Paradise**. Yet fourteen centuries later, many Muslims still deny daughters the rights Islam gave them.

(2) The rights of daughters granted by Islam

(i) The right to life

✦ QURAN

﴿... وَلَا تَقْتُلُوا أَوْلَادَكُمْ مِمَّنْ إِمْلَقَ نَحْنُ نَرْزُقُكُمْ وَإِيَّاهُمْ ...﴾

"Do not kill your children out of poverty; We provide for you and for them." (Al-An'am, Quran)

→ 'Do not kill your children out of poverty; We provide for you and for them.'

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِذَا الْمَوْءُودَةُ سُئِلَتْ بِأَيِّ ذَنْبٍ قُتِلَتْ﴾

"And when the girl [who was] buried alive is asked. For what sin she was killed." (At-Takwir, Quran)

→ The girl buried alive will be asked for what sin she was killed.

(ii) A gift, not a burden

✦ QURAN

﴿لِلَّهِ مُلْكُ السَّمٰوٰتِ وَالْاَرْضِ ۚ يَخْلُقُ مَا يَشَآءُ ۚ يَهَبُ لِمَن يَشَآءُ اُنْثٰى وَيَهَبُ لِمَن يَشَآءُ الذَّكَوْرَ ﴿١﴾ اَوْ يُزَوِّجُهُمْ ذَكَرًا وَّاُنْثٰى وَيَجْعَلُ مَن يَشَآءُ عَقِيْمًا ۗ اِنَّهُ عَلِيْمٌ قَدِيْرٌ﴾

"To Allah belongs the dominion of the heavens and the earth; He creates what he wills. He gives to whom He wills female [children], and He gives to whom He wills males. Or He makes them [both] males and females, and He renders whom He wills barren. Indeed, He is Knowing and Competent." (Ash-Shura, Quran)

→ Allah **gives daughters** to whom He wills and sons to whom He wills — and daughters are mentioned **first**.

(iii) Love and equal treatment

✦ HADITH

اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ وَاعْدِلُوا بَيْنَ أَوْلَادِكُمْ

“Fear Allah and be just between your children.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

✦ HADITH

فَاطِمَةُ بَضْعَةٌ مِنِّي، فَمَنْ أَغْضَبَهَا أَغْضَبَنِي

“Fatimah is a part of me; whoever angers her angers me.” (Al-Bukhari)

→ He stood when she entered and seated her in his place.

(iv) Paradise for raising them well

✦ HADITH

مَنْ عَالَ جَارِيتَيْنِ حَتَّى تَبْلُغَا، جَاءَ يَوْمَ الْقِيَامَةِ أَنَا وَهُوَ — وَضَمَّ أَصَابِعَهُ

“Whoever raises two daughters until they grow up will come on the Day of Resurrection with me like this — and he joined his fingers.” (Muslim)

✦ HADITH

مَنْ ابْتُلِيَ مِنْ هَذِهِ الْبَنَاتِ بِشَيْءٍ فَأَحْسَنَ إِلَيْهِنَّ كُنَّ لَهُ سِتْرًا مِنَ النَّارِ

“Whoever is tested with daughters and treats them well, they will be a shield for him from the Fire.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

(v) Education and upbringing

✦ HADITH

طَلَبُ الْعِلْمِ فَرِيضَةٌ عَلَى كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ

“Seeking knowledge is obligatory on every Muslim.” (Ibn Majah)

The Prophet ﷺ set a day for teaching women (Al-Bukhari); Hazrat Aishah (RA) became a teacher of the Ummah.

(vi) Consent in marriage

✦ HADITH

لَا تُنْكَحُ الْأَيِّمُ حَتَّى تُسْتَأْمَرَ، وَلَا تُنْكَحُ الْبِكْرُ حَتَّى تُسْتَأْذَنَ

“A previously married woman is not married without consultation, nor a virgin without her permission.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Khansa bint Khidam was married against her will; the Prophet ﷺ **annulled** the marriage (Al-Bukhari).

(vii) Mahr, maintenance and inheritance

✦ QURAN

﴿لِّلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ مِمَّا قَلَّ مِنْهُ أَوْ كَثُرَ نَصِيبًا مَّفْرُوضًا﴾

“For men is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, and for women is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, be it little or much - an obligatory share.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For women is a share of inheritance — **little or much, an obligatory share.**

Her **mahr** is hers (An-Nisa 4); her father maintains her until marriage.

DAUGHTER	WIFE	MOTHER	CITIZEN
right to life (At-Takwir)	mahr — hers alone	three times the father's right (Al-Bukhari)	equal reward (Al-Ahzab 35)
equal love and care	maintenance (nafaqah)	Paradise under her feet	education and work
education	kind treatment (An-Nisa 19)	maintenance by children	trade and property
consent in marriage	khula; fair divorce	inheritance: one-sixth	opinion and consultation
inheritance	own property and name	honour in old age	protection of honour

Figure 18 · A woman's rights at every stage — beginning as a daughter.

(3) How these rights are denied by Muslims today

Denial	What happens	Islamic ruling
Neglect at birth	Grief at a girl's birth; less food, care and health spending on girls	An-Nahl 58–59 condemns it
Education	About 26 million children out of school in Pakistan — girls the majority	Knowledge obligatory for all
Forced and early marriage	Marriage without consent; <i>vani</i> and <i>swara</i> — girls given to settle feuds	Consent required; Khansa's marriage annulled
Inheritance	Sisters pressed to 'gift' their share (haq bakhshwana)	An-Nisa 7; the limits of Allah (An-Nisa 13–14)
Dowry (jahez)	Parents in debt; girls unmarried	Not required; mahr is the husband's duty
Honour killing	Hundreds of cases a year (HRCP)	Murder (Al-Ma'idah 32)
Marriage to the Quran	To keep land in the family	A mockery of the Book
Unequal love	Sons preferred in gifts and attention	'Be just between your children'

(4) Why — the causes

- **Tribal and feudal custom** (keeping land in the family).
- **Poverty** and the cost of dowry.
- **Ignorance** of Islam's teaching — custom mistaken for religion.
- **Weak enforcement** of law.

(5) The remedy

- **Law:** the **Prevention of Anti-Women Practices Act 2011** — PPC **310A** (vani, swara), **498A** (denial of inheritance), **498B** (forced marriage), **498C** (marriage with the Quran); the **2016** honour-killing law; the **Enforcement of Women's Property Rights Act 2020**; Constitution Articles **25, 34, 35**.
- **Education:** girls' schools; teaching the ulema and imams to preach these rights in Friday sermons.
- **Society:** simple marriages; ending dowry culture; honouring fathers of daughters.

(6) Conclusion

Islam made the daughter **a gift, a trust and a road to Paradise**, with rights to life, love, education, consent and inheritance. The practices that deny her these rights are not Islam but **custom and greed**, and Islam itself is the strongest argument against them. The Muslim who denies his daughter's rights opposes the Quran he recites.

Why this answer scores

- **Both limbs** answered: rights with evidence, and denial with facts, rulings and causes.
- The honest '**denied by Muslims**' section is exactly what the examiner asked for.
- Pakistani law (2011, 2016, 2020) gives the answer **contemporary depth**.

Answer 9 · The Right of Inheritance Granted to Women by Islam (CSS 2017)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2017 · Q3 · 20 marks

Write a comprehensive note on the right of inheritance granted to women by Islam.

Comprehensive = background, Quranic shares, the wisdom of 2:1, equal-or-more cases, rules, and today's denial.

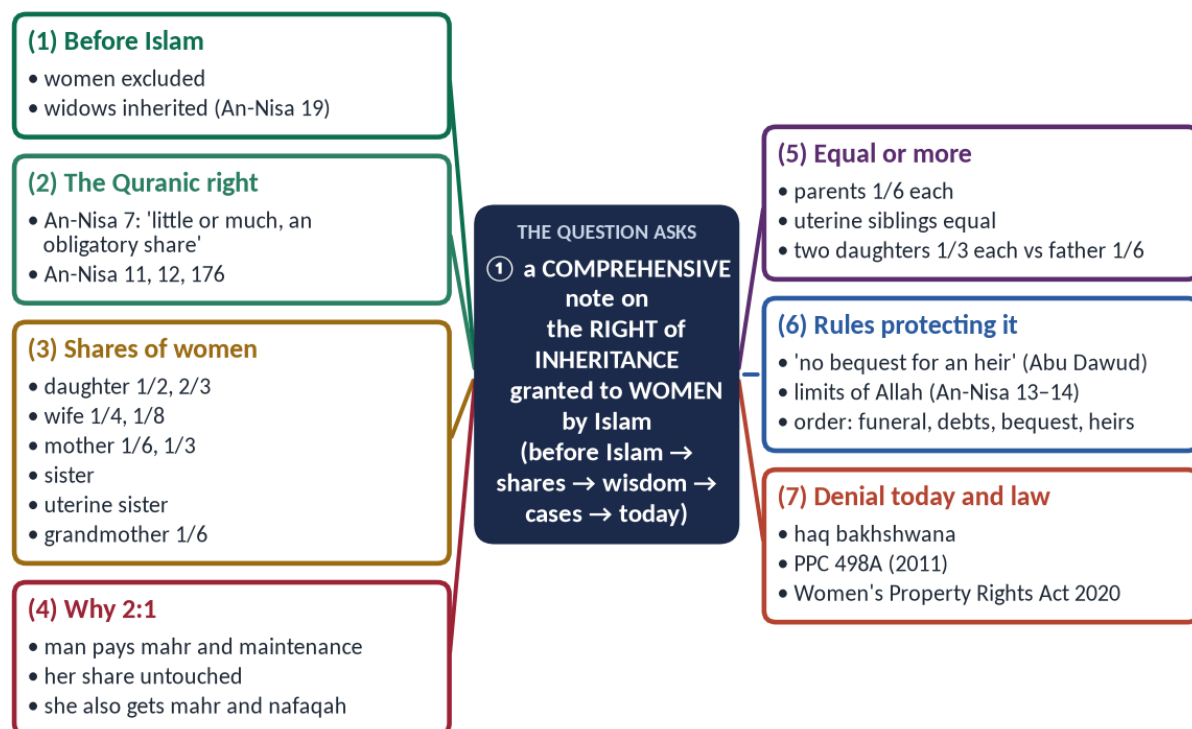


Figure 19 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Comprehensive note'** = all sides: background, the shares, the reason for differences, cases of equality, legal protections, and the present situation.
- Show **figures and a table** — this question rewards precision.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Before Islam, Arab women inherited nothing; the rule was 'only he who carries the sword inherits'. Widows were themselves inherited by the husband's heirs.

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ...﴾

“And live with them in kindness.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ It is **not lawful for you to inherit women** against their will.

Islam made the woman an **heir in her own right** — as daughter, wife, mother, sister and grandmother — and fixed her share in the Quran itself.

(2) The Quranic declaration of the right

✦ QURAN

﴿لِّلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ مِمَّا قَلَّ مِنْهُ أَوْ كَثُرَ نَصِيبًا مَّفْرُوضًا﴾

“For men is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, and for women is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, be it little or much - an obligatory share.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For men is a share of what parents and relatives leave, **and for women is a share — little or much, an obligatory share** (nasiban mafrudan).

The occasion: the widow of **Aws ibn Thabit** (or, in another report, of **Sa'd ibn al-Rabi'**) complained that her daughters had been left nothing; the verses of inheritance were revealed and their shares fixed (Abu Dawud; Al-Tirmidhi).

(3) The shares of women in the Quran

✦ QURAN

﴿يُوصِيكُمُ اللَّهُ فِي أَوْلَادِكُمُ لِلذَّكَرِ مِثْلُ حَظِّ الْأُنثِيَيْنِ...﴾

“Allah instructs you concerning your children: for the male, the like of the share of two females.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Allah instructs you concerning your children: for the male, **the like of the share of two females**.

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَلَهُنَّ الرُّبُعُ مِمَّا تَرَكْتُمْ إِنْ لَمْ يَكُنْ لَكُمْ وَلَدٌ فَإِنْ كَانَ لَكُمْ وَلَدٌ فَلَهُنَّ الثُّمُنُ مِمَّا تَرَكْتُمْ...﴾

“And for the wives is one-fourth of what you leave if you have no child; but if you have a child, then for them is one-eighth.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For the wives is **one-fourth** if you leave no child; **one-eighth** if you leave a child.

Heir	Share
Daughter	Alone: 1/2 ; two or more: 2/3 shared; with a son: half his share (An-Nisa 11)
Wife (one or more, shared)	1/4 without children of the deceased; 1/8 with children (An-Nisa 12)
Mother	1/6 with children or two+ siblings; otherwise 1/3 (An-Nisa 11)
Full sister	With no child or father: 1/2 ; two+: 2/3 ; with a brother: half his share (An-Nisa 176)
Uterine sister	1/6 ; two+ share 1/3 equally with uterine brothers (An-Nisa 12)

Heir	Share
Grandmother	1/6 (Sunnah)

(4) Why a son receives twice a daughter — the wisdom

- (a) The man pays **mahr** and must **maintain** his wife, children and often parents and unmarried sisters; the woman must maintain **no one**, not even herself.
- (b) Her share is **entirely hers**; his is largely spent on others.
- (c) She gains from **several sources** — inheritance, mahr and maintenance.
- (d) The **2:1** rule applies only where a man and a woman stand in the **same relation** with the same duties — son and daughter, brother and sister, husband and wife; it is not a general rule for all women.

(5) Cases where women receive equal or more

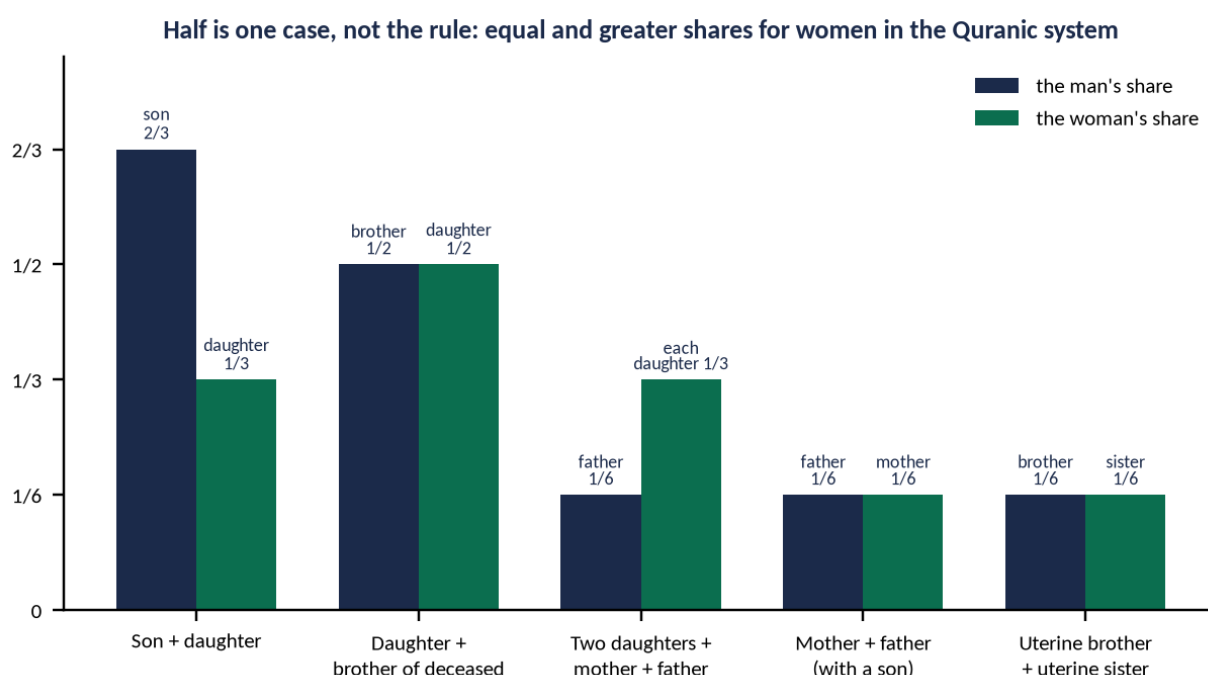


Figure 20 · Equal and greater shares for women.

- **Father and mother** of a deceased with a son: **1/6 each** — equal.
- **Uterine brother and sister**: equal.
- **Daughter** with the deceased's **brother**: **1/2 each** — equal.
- **Two daughters with both parents**: each daughter **1/3**, father **1/6** — a woman receives **twice** a man.

(6) Rules that protect her share

✦ HADITH

إِنَّ اللَّهَ قَدْ أَعْطَى كُلَّ ذِي حَقٍّ حَقَّهُ، فَلَا وَصِيَّةَ لَوَارِثٍ

“Allah has given every rightful person his right; there is no bequest for an heir.” (Abu Dawud and Al-Tirmidhi)

→ No one can **cut her out** by will.

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَمَنْ يَعْصِ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ وَيَتَعَدَّ حُدُودَهُ يُدْخِلْهُ نَارًا خَالِدًا فِيهَا وَلَهُ عَذَابٌ مُهِينٌ﴾

“And whoever disobeys Allah and His Messenger and transgresses His limits — He will put him into the Fire to abide therein, and he will have a humiliating punishment.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Whoever disobeys Allah and **transgresses His limits** — the Fire; the warning that closes the inheritance verses.

Order of distribution (Hanafi): funeral expenses → **debts** (including her unpaid mahr) → bequest up to **one-third**, not to an heir → shares to the **sharers**, then the **residuaries**.

(7) The denial of women's inheritance today

In rural Pakistan, sisters and daughters are pressured to give up their share (**haq bakhshwana**), or are married within the family to keep the land.

- **PPC 498A (2011):** depriving a woman of inheritance by deceit or coercion — **5 to 10 years'** imprisonment.
- **Enforcement of Women's Property Rights Act 2020** — an ombudsperson to restore property quickly.
- The courts have held that a woman's relinquishment must be **free and informed**.

TRAP · 'HALF THE SHARE' IS NOT 'HALF THE VALUE'

Never write that Islam values a woman at half a man. Show the man's **financial duties** and the **cases of equal or greater shares**.

(8) Conclusion

Islam turned the woman from **property that was inherited** into **an heir who inherits** — with fixed shares no father, brother or will can remove. The 2:1 rule in one case is balanced by the man's financial duties, and in many cases she receives an equal or larger share. The real injustice today is not in the Quranic law but in its **denial by custom** — which Islam itself calls a transgression of the limits of Allah.

Why this answer scores

- **Comprehensive:** background, verses, a share table, wisdom, equal-share cases, legal rules and the present day.
- A **figure** and **exact fractions** show mastery.
- It answers the common objection (2:1) **with facts**.

Answer 10 · The Rights of Women in Islam and the Current Wave of Feminism (CSS 2019)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2019 · Q4 · 20 marks

Describe the rights of women in Islam in the context of current wave of the feminist movement.

Describe feminism briefly, then women's rights in Islam against its demands, then the balanced Islamic position.

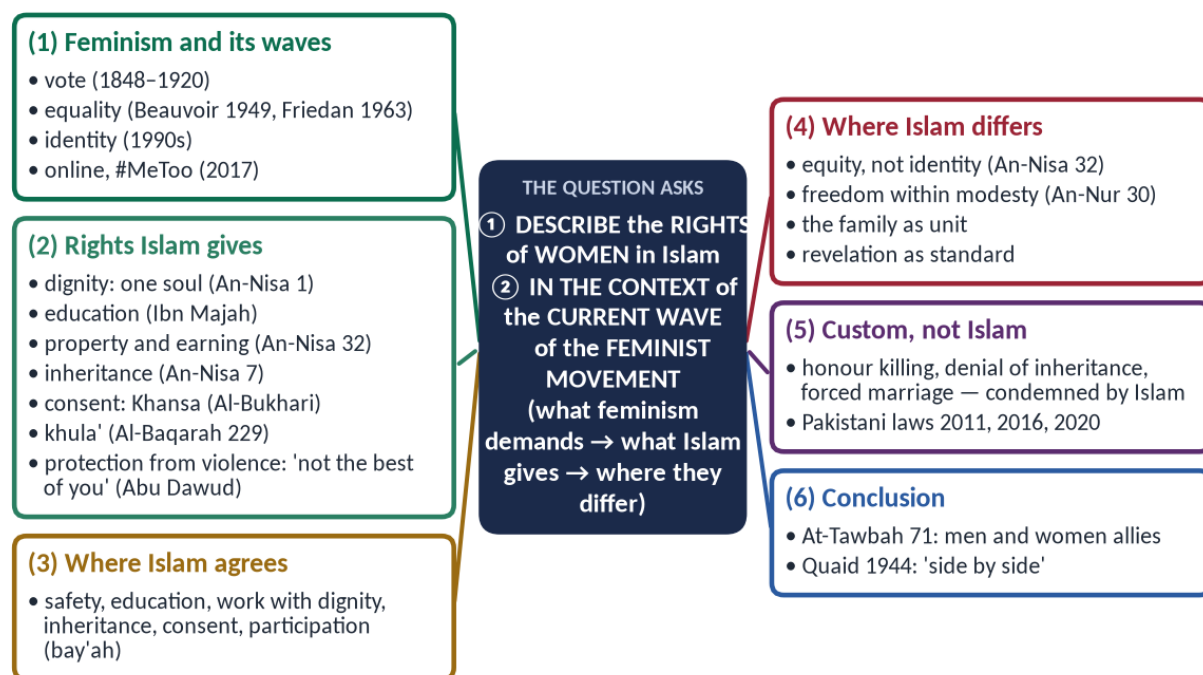


Figure 21 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- 'Describe the rights of women in Islam' — the main body.
- 'In the context of the current wave of the feminist movement' — show **which demands of feminism Islam already meets**, where it **differs**, and why.
- Avoid both extremes — rejecting every demand, or accepting every slogan.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

Feminism is the movement for the political, economic and social equality of women. Its current (fourth) wave, since about **2012**, works through social media and street campaigns against harassment and violence (**#MeToo**, 2017) and for body autonomy. In Pakistan too, women's marches and online campaigns have made women's rights a national debate. Islam's answer is neither denial nor imitation: it gave women their rights **fourteen centuries ago** — within a framework of family and morality.

(2) The feminist movement — its waves

Wave	Period	Main demands
First	1848–1920	Vote and property (Seneca Falls, 1848)
Second	1960s–1980s	Equal pay, education, family law (Beauvoir, 1949; Friedan, 1963)
Third	1990s–2000s	Diversity, identity, choice
Fourth (current)	2012 onwards	Online activism; harassment and violence (#MeToo, 2017); body autonomy

(3) The rights of women in Islam

(i) Equal humanity and dignity

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً﴾

﴿...﴾

“O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ Men and women created **from one soul**.

✦ HADITH

إِنَّمَا النِّسَاءُ شَقَائِقُ الرِّجَالِ

“Women are the twin halves of men.” (Abu Dawud and Al-Tirmidhi)

(ii) Education

✦ HADITH

طَلَبُ الْعِلْمِ فَرِيضَةٌ عَلَى كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ

“Seeking knowledge is obligatory on every Muslim.” (Ibn Majah)

(iii) Property, earning and inheritance

✦ QURAN

﴿... لِلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا كَسَبُوا وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا كَسَبْنَ...﴾

“For men is a share of what they have earned, and for women is a share of what they have earned.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For women is a **share of what they have earned**.

✦ QURAN

﴿لِّلرِّجَالِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ وَلِلنِّسَاءِ نَصِيبٌ مِّمَّا تَرَكَ الْوَالِدَانِ وَالْأَقْرَبُونَ مِمَّا قَلَّ مِنْهُ أَوْ كَثُرَ نَصِيبًا مَّفْرُوضًا﴾

“For men is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, and for women is a share of what the parents and close relatives leave, be it little or much - an obligatory share.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ For women is a share of inheritance — **an obligatory share**.

Khadijah (RA) ran a great trading business; **Al-Shifa bint Abdullah** supervised the market under Umar (RA).

(iv) Consent and freedom in marriage

✦ HADITH

لَا تُنْكَحُ الْأَيِّمُ حَتَّى تُسْتَأْمَرَ، وَلَا تُنْكَحُ الْبِكْرُ حَتَّى تُسْتَأْذَنَ

“A previously married woman is not married without consultation, nor a virgin without her permission.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Mahr is hers (An-Nisa 4); she may seek **khula'** (Al-Baqarah 229).

(v) Protection from violence and harassment

✦ HADITH

لَيْسَ أَوْلَئِكَ بِخَيْرٍ كُمْ

“Those (men who beat their wives) are not the best of you.” (Abu Dawud)

→ The Prophet ﷺ **never struck a woman** (Muslim).

✦ QURAN

﴿قُلْ لِّلْمُؤْمِنِينَ يَغُضُّوا مِنْ أَبْصَارِهِمْ وَيَحْفَظُوا فُرُوجَهُمْ ذَلِكَ أَزْكَى لَهُمْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ خَبِيرٌ بِمَا يَصْنَعُونَ﴾

“Tell the believing men to reduce [some] of their vision and guard their private parts. That is purer for them. Indeed, Allah is Acquainted with what they do.” (An-Nur, Quran)

→ **The believing men** are commanded first to lower their gaze — harassment is condemned at its source.

A false accusation of unchastity: **eighty lashes** (An-Nur 4).

(vi) Participation in public life

Women gave the **bay'ah** (Al-Mumtahanah 12); **Umm Salamah** advised the Prophet ﷺ at Hudaibiyyah; **Rufaydah** nursed the wounded.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَالْمُؤْمِنُونَ وَالْمُؤْمِنَاتُ بَعْضُهُمْ أَوْلِيَاءُ بَعْضٍ يَأْمُرُونَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ وَيَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ ...﴾

“The believing men and believing women are allies of one another; they enjoin what is right and forbid what is wrong.” (At-Tawbah, Quran)

→ 'The believing men and believing women are allies of one another.'

(4) Where Islam agrees with the demands of the movement

Demand	Islam
Safety from violence and harassment	An-Nur 30; 'not the best of you'
Education	Obligatory for all
Economic independence	Her property and earnings are hers
Inheritance	A fixed, obligatory share
Consent in marriage and right to divorce	Required; khula'
Participation	Bay'ah; counsel; work with dignity

(5) Where Islam differs

- **(a) Equity, not identity:** equal dignity, **complementary** roles — the man maintains, the woman is free of financial duty (An-Nisa 32, 34).
- **(b) Freedom within modesty:** Islam rejects sexual freedom outside marriage and the commercial use of women's bodies — which it regards as **exploitation**.
- **(c) The family as the unit:** motherhood is honour ('Paradise is beneath her feet' — Al-Nasa'i), not oppression.
- **(d) Revelation as the standard:** fixed rights (inheritance, mahr, maintenance) are **not open to repeal** by changing opinion.

DEBATE · THE SLOGANS AND THE SUBSTANCE

Some slogans of recent campaigns offended many Pakistanis; the **substance** — safety, inheritance, education, consent — is Islamic. The wise answer is to **accept the substance with Islamic evidence** and reject what attacks modesty or the family.

(6) Custom, not Islam — the real oppressor

Honour killing, denial of inheritance, forced marriage (vani, swara), dowry and denial of education are **tribal customs** that Islam condemns. Pakistan has criminalised them: the **2011** Anti-Women Practices Act (PPC 310A, 498A–C), the **2016** honour-killing law, the **2010** workplace-harassment law, and the **2020** property-rights Act.

Women's rights and feminism — the names only		
Islam gives	Islam agrees	Islam differs
dignity	safety	equity not identity
education	schooling	modesty
property and inheritance	economic independence	family as unit
consent and khula'	consent	revelation as standard — custom is the real oppressor
protection from violence	public role	
participation		

Figure 22 · At a glance — women's rights and feminism — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(7) Conclusion

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Quaid-e-Azam Muhammad Ali Jinnah · Speech at Aligarh, 1944

No nation can rise to the height of glory unless its women are side by side with its men.

→ The founder's vision for Pakistan.

Islam met most of the just demands of the feminist movement long before the movement began, and grounded them in faith rather than struggle. It differs where feminism would separate woman from family and modesty. Pakistan's task is to give women **the rights Islam already gave** — and that alone would answer the movement.

Why this answer scores

- It **describes the rights** fully and places them **in the context of feminism** — agreement and difference.
- It separates **Islam from custom** and cites Pakistani law.
- Balanced tone — no rejection of just demands, no acceptance of anti-family slogans.

Answer 11 · The Stability of Modern Society Depends on a Strong Family System (CSS 2015)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2015 · Q8 · 16 marks

Stability of modern society depends upon a strong family system in the light of Islamic principles. Discuss.

Family in Islam → its functions for society → Islamic principles that keep it strong → what happens when it fails.

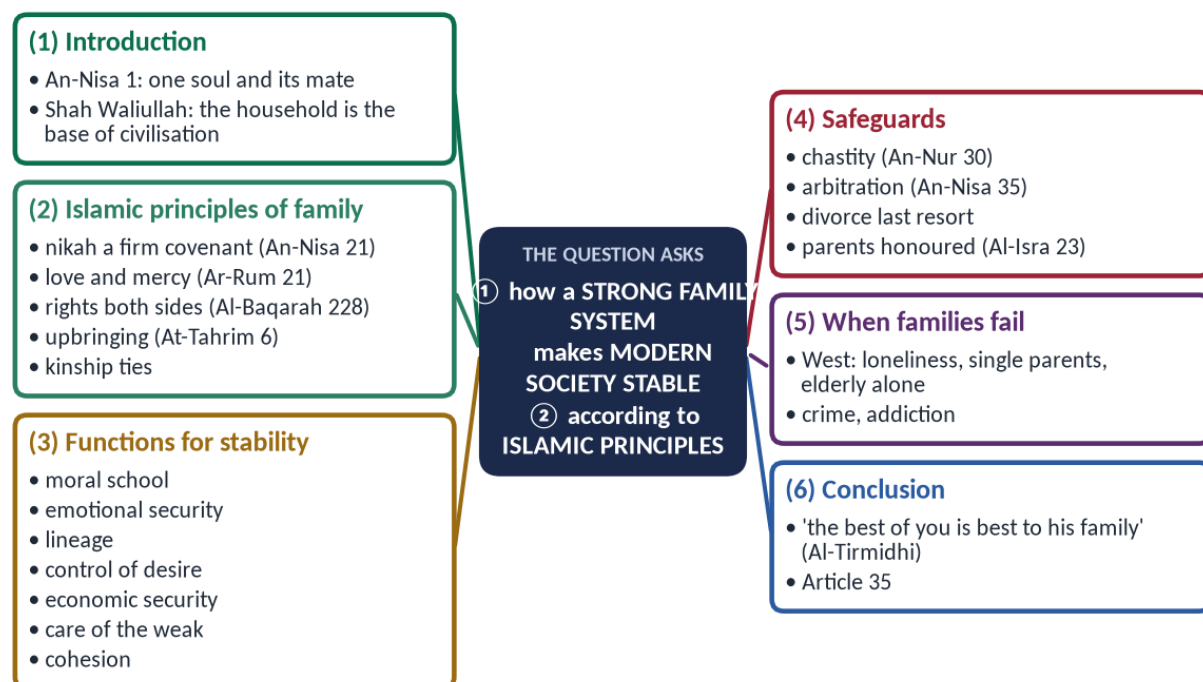


Figure 23 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- **'Stability of modern society depends upon a strong family'** — show the **link**: which family functions keep society stable.
- **'In the light of Islamic principles'** — the Islamic structure and safeguards of the family.
- **16 marks** — a slightly shorter answer.

The model answer

(1) Introduction

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً

﴿...﴾

“O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women.” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ All people come **from one soul and its mate** — the family is the first human institution.

✦ SCHOLARLY VIEW

Shah Waliullah Dehlawi · Hujjat Allah al-Baligha

Shah Waliullah described the household (tadbir al-manzil) as the second stage of civilisation, from which the neighbourhood, the city and the state grow; if the household is corrupt, all that is built on it is corrupted.

→ The family is **the base of civilisation**.

Modern society has schools, police, courts and welfare agencies, yet none can replace the family. When the family is strong, society is stable; when it breaks, no institution can repair the damage.

(2) The Islamic principles of the family

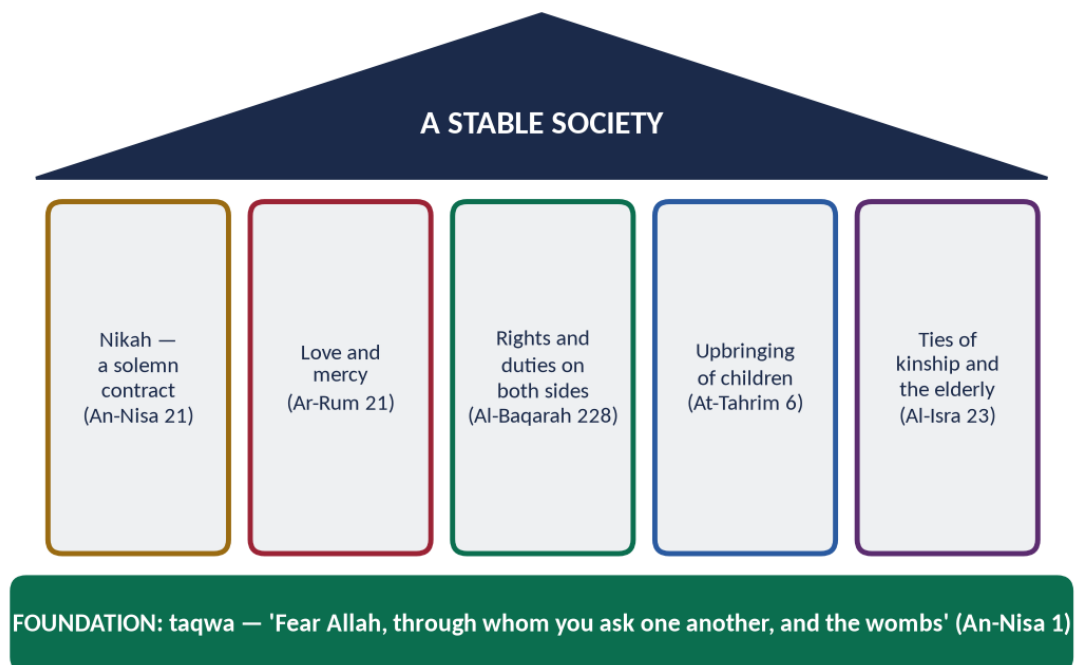


Figure 24 · The Islamic family: foundation, pillars and roof.

- **(a) Nikah — a firm covenant:** 'they have taken from you a **firm covenant**' (An-Nisa 21) — consent, witnesses, mahr.
- **(b) Love and mercy:**

✦ QURAN

﴿وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ أَنْ خَلَقَ لَكُمْ مِنْ أَنْفُسِكُمْ أَزْوَاجًا لِتَسْكُنُوا إِلَيْهَا وَجَعَلَ بَيْنَكُمْ مَوَدَّةً وَرَحْمَةً إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ﴾

“And of His signs is that He created for you from yourselves mates that you may find tranquillity in them; and He placed between you affection and mercy. Indeed in that are signs for a people who give thought.” (Ar-Rum, Quran)

→ He placed between you **love and mercy** — the family's emotional core.

- **(c) Rights and duties on both sides:** 'women have rights like their obligations' (Al-Baqarah 228).
- **(d) Upbringing of children:**

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا قُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ وَأَهْلِيكُمْ نَارًا وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ عَلَيْهَا مَلَائِكَةٌ غِلَظٌ شِدَادٌ لَا يَعْصُونَ اللَّهَ مَا أَمَرَهُمْ وَيَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ﴾

“O you who have believed, protect yourselves and your families from a Fire whose fuel is people and stones, over which are [appointed] angels, harsh and severe; they do not disobey Allah in what He commands them but do what they are commanded.” (At-Tahrim, Quran)

→ 'Protect yourselves and your families from a Fire.'

- **(e) Honour of parents and kinship ties:** not even 'uff' (Al-Isra 23); 'whoever wants his provision increased, let him keep ties with relatives' (Al-Bukhari and Muslim).

(3) How a strong family keeps society stable

Function	Contribution to social stability
Moral school	Honesty, respect and faith learned at home produce law-abiding citizens
Emotional security	Love and mercy prevent loneliness, depression and addiction
Lineage and identity	Clear parentage; rights of names and inheritance
Lawful channel of desire	Marriage reduces adultery, disease and sexual crime
Economic security	Husband maintains wife and children; children maintain parents
Care of the weak	Children, the elderly and the disabled cared for without the state
Social cohesion	Kinship ties link families into communities

(4) Islamic safeguards that keep the family strong

- **Chastity and modesty** (An-Nur 30–31) protect the marriage.
- **Arbitration before divorce:**

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِنْ خِفْتُمْ شِقَاقَ بَيْنِهِمَا فَابْعَثُوا حَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهِ ۚ وَحَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا إِن يُرِيدَا إِصْلَاحًا يُوَفِّقِ اللَّهُ بَيْنَهُمَا ۚ إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَلِيمًا خَبِيرًا﴾

“And if you fear dissension between the two, send an arbitrator from his people and an arbitrator from her people. If they both desire reconciliation, Allah will cause it between them. Indeed, Allah is ever Knowing and Acquainted [with all things].” (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ **Appoint an arbiter from his family and an arbiter from her family**; if they want reconciliation, Allah will bring it about.

- **Divorce as a last resort**, in stages, with a waiting period for reconsideration.
- **Kindness at home:**

✦ HADITH

خَيْرُكُمْ خَيْرُكُمْ لِأَهْلِهِ، وَأَنَا خَيْرُكُمْ لِأَهْلِي

“The best of you is the best to his family, and I am the best of you to my family.” (Al-Tirmidhi)

(5) What happens when the family fails — the modern evidence

In many industrial societies, the decline of marriage and the rise of single-parent homes have been linked with child poverty, school dropout, loneliness among the elderly, and addiction. Governments now spend heavily on problems the family once prevented. In Pakistan, rising divorce, neglect of parents and drug use among the young show the same danger.

Family and social stability — the names only		
Islamic principles	Functions	Safeguards
firm covenant	moral school	chastity
love and mercy	emotional security	arbitration (An-Nisa 35)
rights both sides	lineage	divorce last resort
upbringing	lawful desire	kindness at home
parents and kin	economic security	
	care of the weak	
	cohesion	

Figure 25 · At a glance — family and social stability — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(6) Conclusion

Pakistan's Constitution commits the state to **protect marriage, the family, the mother and the child** (Article 35). Islam's principles — a solemn covenant, love and mercy, balanced rights, moral upbringing and care of parents — make the family strong, and a strong family is the **first guarantee** of a stable, moral and peaceful society.

Why this answer scores

- It proves the **link** between family and social stability, function by function.
- Islamic principles and safeguards are **Quran-based**; Shah Waliullah gives depth.

- Proportionate length for **16 marks**.

Answer 12 · The Challenges for the Institution of Family in the Present Era (CSS 2026)

THE QUESTION · CSS 2026 · Q8 · 20 marks

What are the challenges for the 'institution of family and its role' in the present era? Discuss them in the light of Islamic teachings.

For each challenge: what it is → what Islam teaches → the remedy.

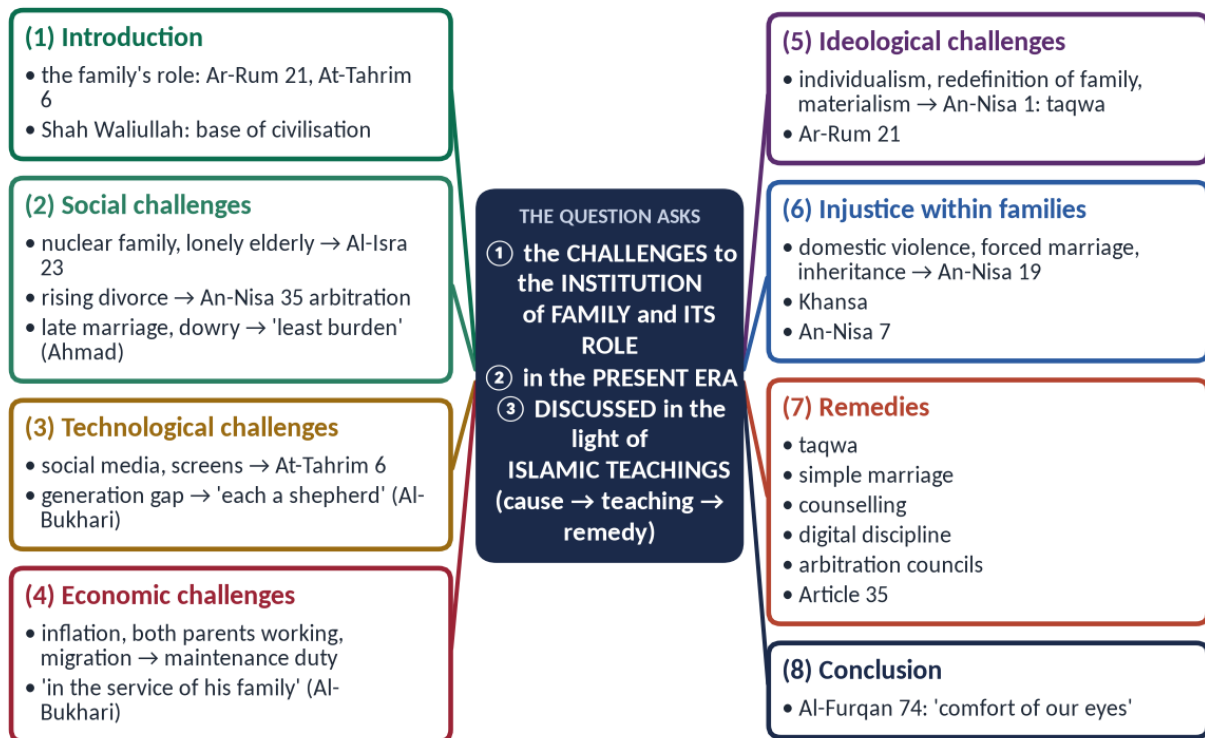


Figure 26 · The answer map: every branch is one numbered heading of the model answer below.

Decoding the question

- '**Challenges**' = list and explain the present-day threats — grouped (social, technological, economic, ideological, internal).
- '**Institution of family and its role**' = show how each challenge weakens the family's **role** (moral school, security, care).
- '**In the light of Islamic teachings**' = for each challenge, the **Islamic teaching** and **remedy**.

The model answer

(1) Introduction — the role of the family

✦ QURAN

﴿وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ أَنْ خَلَقَ لَكُمْ مِنْ أَنْفُسِكُمْ أَزْوَاجًا لِتَسْكُنُوا إِلَيْهَا وَجَعَلَ بَيْنَكُمْ مَوَدَّةً وَرَحْمَةً إِنَّ فِي ذَلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ﴾

“And of His signs is that He created for you from yourselves mates that you may find tranquillity in them; and He placed between you affection and mercy. Indeed in that are signs for a people who give thought.” (Ar-Rum, Quran)

→ Spouses were created **that you may find tranquillity**; He placed between you **love and mercy**.

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا قُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ وَأَهْلِيكُمْ نَارًا وَقُودُهَا النَّاسُ وَالْحِجَارَةُ عَلَيْهَا مَلَائِكَةٌ غِلَظٌ شِدَادٌ لَا يَعْصُونَ اللَّهَ مَا أَمَرَهُمْ وَيَفْعَلُونَ مَا يُؤْمَرُونَ﴾

“O you who have believed, protect yourselves and your families from a Fire whose fuel is people and stones, over which are [appointed] angels, harsh and severe; they do not disobey Allah in what He commands them but do what they are commanded.” (At-Tahrim, Quran)

→ ‘Protect yourselves and your families from a Fire’ — the family is the first school of faith and character.

The family's role is to give love, security, moral training and care to every generation. In the present era, this role faces challenges that did not exist a generation ago.

(2) Social challenges

(i) From joint to nuclear family

Urbanisation and migration have broken the joint family; the elderly are left alone and old-age homes are growing in big cities.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَقَضَىٰ رَبُّكَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ وَبِالْوَالِدَيْنِ إِحْسَنًا ۖ إِنَّمَا يُبَلِّغَنَّ عَنْكَ الْكِبَرُ أَحَدُهُمَا أَوْ كِلَاهُمَا فَلَا تَقُلْ لَهُمَا أُفٍّ وَلَا تَنْهَرْهُمَا وَقُلْ لَهُمَا قَوْلًا كَرِيمًا﴾

“Your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him, and that you be good to parents. If one or both of them reach old age with you, do not say to them even ‘uff’, nor repel them, but speak to them a noble word.” (Al-Isra, Quran)

→ Do not say **even ‘uff’** to parents in old age — their care is the family's duty.

(ii) Rising divorce and khula'

Family courts in Pakistan's cities hear many thousands of cases every year; children suffer most.

✦ QURAN

﴿وَإِنْ خِفْتُمْ شِقَاقَ بَيْنِهِمَا فَابْعَثُوا حَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهِ وَحَكَمًا مِّنْ أَهْلِهَا إِنْ يُرِيدَا إِصْلَاحًا يُوَفِّقِ اللَّهُ بَيْنَهُمَا إِنَّ اللَّهَ كَانَ عَلِيمًا خَبِيرًا﴾

"And if you fear dissension between the two, send an arbitrator from his people and an arbitrator from her people. If they both desire reconciliation, Allah will cause it between them. Indeed, Allah is ever Knowing and Acquainted [with all things]." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ **Arbiters from both families** — reconciliation before separation.

(iii) Late marriage and dowry

Expensive weddings and **jahez** delay marriage and burden parents.

✦ HADITH

إِنَّ أَعْظَمَ النِّكَاحِ بَرَكَةً أَيْسَرُهُ مَوْئِنَةً

"The most blessed marriage is the one with the least burden." (Musnad Ahmad)

→ **Simple marriage** is Sunnah.

(3) Technological challenges

(i) Social media and screens

Less time together, comparison and jealousy, exposure of children to harmful content, online harassment.

(ii) The generation gap

Parents and children living in different worlds of language and values.

✦ HADITH

كُلُّكُمْ رَاعٍ وَكُلُّكُمْ مَسْئُولٌ عَنْ رَعِيَّتِهِ

"Each of you is a shepherd, and each is responsible for his flock." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

→ Parents must **guide**, not abandon, their children in the digital world.

(4) Economic challenges

(i) Inflation and unemployment

Money stress causes quarrels and long working hours for both parents.

(ii) Migration

Fathers working abroad for years; children raised by one parent.

The Sunnah balances earning with presence: the Prophet ﷺ 'used to be in the service of his family' (Al-Bukhari); the husband's duty of **maintenance** (At-Talaq 6) is matched by his duty of **time and care**.

(5) Ideological challenges

(i) Individualism

Marriage seen as a contract of convenience rather than a **firm covenant** (An-Nisa 21).

(ii) Redefinition of family and gender roles in global media

Islam holds the family to be the union of a man and a woman in nikah, with complementary roles (An-Nisa 1, 34).

(iii) Materialism

Success measured by money, not character — parents with no time for children's moral upbringing.

✦ QURAN

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اتَّقُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ مِنْ نَفْسٍ وَاحِدَةٍ وَخَلَقَ مِنْهَا زَوْجَهَا وَبَثَّ مِنْهُمَا رِجَالًا كَثِيرًا وَنِسَاءً﴾
﴿...﴾

"O mankind, fear your Lord, who created you from one soul, created from it its mate, and spread from both of them many men and women." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ 'Fear Allah, through whom you ask one another, **and the wombs**' — **taqwa and kinship** are the family's foundation.

(6) Injustice within families

Domestic violence, forced marriage, denial of inheritance and neglect of parents weaken the family from within.

✦ QURAN

﴿...وَعَاشِرُوهُنَّ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ...﴾

"And live with them in kindness." (An-Nisa, Quran)

→ 'Live with them in kindness.'

Forced marriage is void in spirit — Khansa's marriage was annulled (Al-Bukhari); daughters have an obligatory share (An-Nisa 7).

Challenges to the family — the names only				
Social	Technological	Economic	Ideological	Internal
nuclear family	social media	inflation	individualism	violence
divorce	screens	both parents working	redefinition	forced marriage
late marriage and dowry	generation gap	migration	materialism	inheritance denied
				parents neglected

Figure 27 · At a glance — challenges to the family — the names only. The detail is in the sections above.

(7) The Islamic remedies

- (a) **Taqwa at the base** (An-Nisa 1).
- (b) **Simple marriage** — end dowry culture ('the least burden').

- (c) **Pre-marriage counselling** on rights and duties; the **nikah nama** explained.
- (d) **Time and presence** — family meals and prayers together; the father as a model.
- (e) **Digital discipline** — screen rules; parental guidance.
- (f) **Arbitration** before divorce — strengthen the **Arbitration Councils** of the Muslim Family Laws Ordinance 1961.
- (g) **Care of the elderly at home** (Al-Isra 23).
- (h) **The state's duty** — Article 35: protect marriage, family, mother and child; family-friendly work, housing and schools.

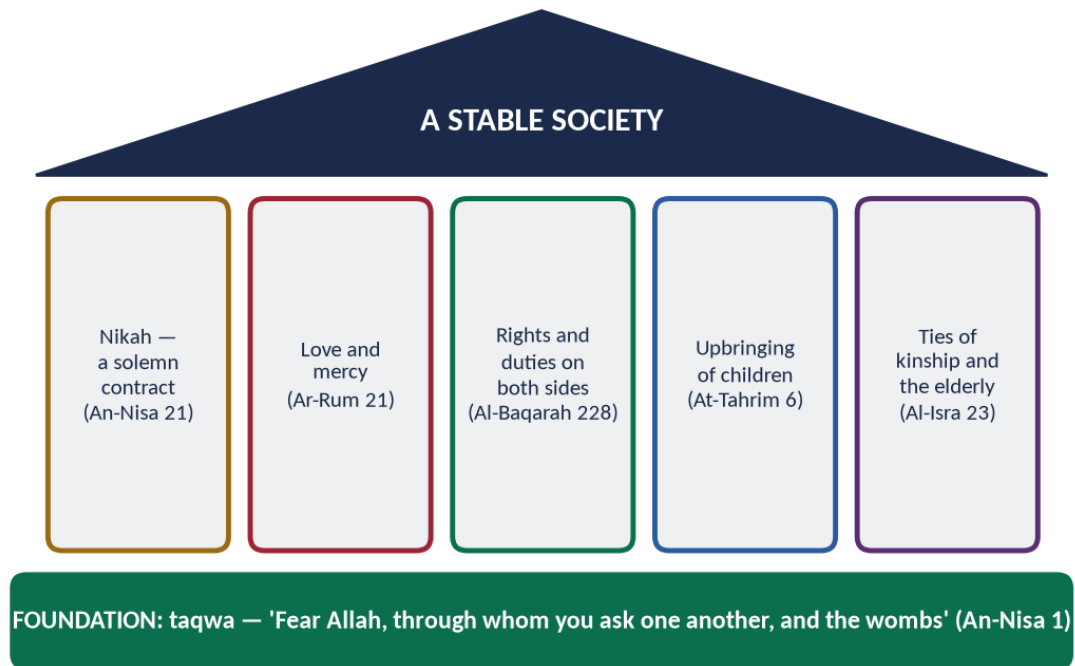


Figure 28 · The Islamic family: the structure that answers these challenges.

(8) Conclusion

✦ QURAN

﴿وَالَّذِينَ يَقُولُونَ رَبَّنَا هَبْ لَنَا مِنْ أَزْوَاجِنَا وَذُرِّيَّاتِنَا قُرَّةَ أَعْيُنٍ وَاجْعَلْنَا لِلْمُتَّقِينَ إِمَامًا﴾

“And those who say, “Our Lord, grant us from among our wives and offspring comfort to our eyes and make us an example for the righteous.” (Al-Furqan, Quran)

→ ‘Our Lord, grant us from our spouses and children **the comfort of our eyes.**’

The family today faces social, technological, economic and ideological pressures, and injustice from within. Islam's teachings answer each: taqwa, love and mercy, simple marriage, balanced rights, moral upbringing, arbitration and care of parents. A society that protects its families protects its future.

Why this answer scores

- Challenges are **grouped** and each is matched with an **Islamic teaching** and **remedy** — exactly ‘in the light of Islamic teachings’.
- It speaks of the family's **role**, as the question's own words require.
- Pakistani references (MFLO 1961, Article 35) make it **contemporary**.